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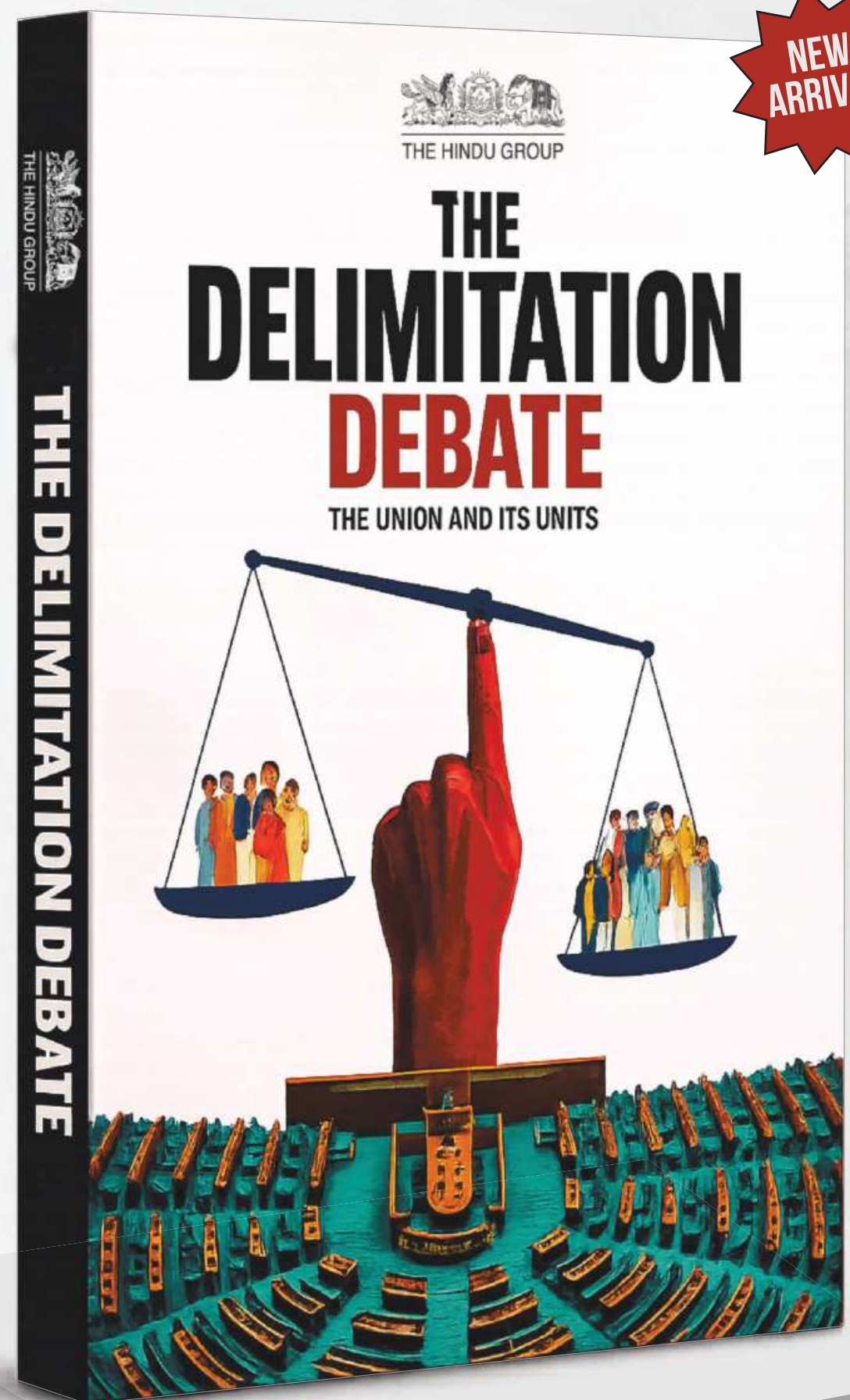
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Be united, Iran leader tells Muslim nations

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Should CJP be a political party?

Success of movement should be judged by participation of youth

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HONOURING A LEGEND

Federer inducted into tennis Hall of Fame

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NEARBY



Business houses in T.N. line up for the IPO route

CHENNAI
Several Tamil Nadu-based business houses are shedding their conservative tag and knocking on SEBI's doors to tap the IPO market. Milky Mist and Lalithaa Jewellery have already gone public. » PAGE 6

Van runs over four children in Dindigul district

DINDIGUL
Four children aged between 5 and 11, including two sisters, were run over by a van near Vadamadurai in Dindigul district on Sunday. » PAGE 6

EDUCATIONPLUS » PAGE 4

India, Uzbekistan upgrade ties, agree on uranium deal

Uzbekistan is at the heart of India's engagement in Central Asia, says PM as the two nations elevate relations to comprehensive strategic partnership and set a \$5 billion annual trade target by 2030

Press Trust of India
TASHKENT

India and Uzbekistan on Sunday decided to elevate their ties to a comprehensive strategic partnership and set a target of \$5 billion in annual trade by 2030 following talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Uzbek President Shavkat Mirziyoyev.

The two sides inked 11 agreements for boosting engagement in several key sectors, including mining and tourism, and agreed to establish a framework for long-term supply of uranium from Uzbekistan to India in line with cooperation in the civil nuclear energy sector.

The talks focused on expanding cooperation in areas of trade, investment,



Hand in hand: Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Uzbekistan President Shavkat Mirziyoyev in Tashkent on Sunday. ANI

infrastructure, critical minerals, mining, defence and security, agriculture, pharmaceuticals, health, information technology, ayurveda, digital public infrastructure, including UPI, and education.

"We are celebrating the 15th anniversary of our strategic partnership. I am

delighted that, on this special occasion, we are elevating our ties to the level of a comprehensive strategic partnership," Mr. Modi said.

"We will move forward by setting concrete goals within this framework," he said. Mr. Modi said both sides would also elevate

their existing joint commission from the level of secretaries to that of ministerial level.

Mr. Mirziyoyev said Uzbekistan was determined to boost ties with India in diverse sectors. "We are aiming to advance cooperation in sectors such as energy, culture, critical minerals, pharmaceuticals, jewellery, and agriculture," the Uzbek President said. The current volume of bilateral trade between the two nations is over \$1 billion.

"Uzbekistan is at the heart of Central Asia and is at the heart of India's engagement in the region," Mr. Modi said.

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PM VISITS MEMORIAL
» PAGE 10



Nature's fury: A house lies partially submerged following the flash flood in Nuwakot district of Nepal. PRABHAT KHANAL

788 dead, over 2,500 still missing in Nepal

Sanjeev Satgajanya
KATHMANDU

Four days after the flood in Nepal, the death toll in the disaster touched 788, and 2,502 people remained missing even as the preservation of recovered bodies became a challenge for the authorities who continued with the rescue efforts.

Foreign Secretary Amrit Bahadur Rai said Nepal urgently required freezer units and DNA-testing kits, warning that the bodies

must be preserved and identified quickly to prevent decomposition and contain public-health risks. He said the government was "putting all our resources at disposal in relief and rescue operations". "We have requested several countries," he said.

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» PAGE 9

'Cong. will quit T.N. Cabinet if Rahul is not accepted as PM candidate'

The Hindu Bureau
NAGERCOIL

Tamil Nadu Tourism Minister S. Rajesh Kumar on Sunday warned that he and his Congress colleague and Higher Education Minister Viswanathan will quit the C. Joseph Vijay-led Cabinet if the TVK continued to push the narrative projecting Mr. Vijay as a prime ministerial candidate for the 2029 parliamentary elections.

"If [Congress leader] Rahul Gandhi is not accepted [by the TVK] as the Prime Minister candidate, both the Congress Ministers will immediately resign from their posts and quit the Cabinet," Mr. Rajesh Kumar said while addressing a party meeting at Marthandam.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6



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T.N. government, National University of Singapore sign MoU on PG programmes

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The State government, through Guidance Tamil Nadu, and the National University of Singapore (NUS) signed an MoU to expand collaboration in postgraduate education and knowledge exchange on Saturday.

The MoU enables government and private universities in Tamil Nadu to create practical collaborative opportunities with NUS through student exchange programmes, immersion programmes, masterclasses, and seminars. It also aims to create scholarship support and co-fund schemes for Tamil Nadu students aiming to pursue postgraduate and Ph.D. programmes at NUS. “Chennai stood out for NUS to begin its journey in



The MoU was signed by Ang Wee Han, Acting Vice Provost (Masters' Programmes and Lifelong Education), NUS, and Deepak Jacob, Managing Director and CEO of Guidance Tamil Nadu on Saturday.

India, as we have shared interests and a commitment to academic excellence. Our goal is to enhance the employability and global readiness of our students,” Deepak Jacob, IAS officer, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of Guidance Tamil Nadu, said. “We are looking to create a sustained presence in Tamil Nadu. By creating a talent pipeline

through Master's and Ph.D. level education, we want students to contribute extensively to the growth of the ASEAN region,” Ang Wee Han, Acting Vice Provost (Masters' Programmes and Lifelong Education), NUS, said. He added that the university was looking forward to giving Indian students a different educational experience which is future-ready but

also rooted in cultural values and traditions. Professor Han and Mr. Jacob signed the MoU at ITC Grand Chola in Chennai. This is the first MoU signed by NUS with a State government in India.

NUS also organised a Postgraduate Fair and masterclasses at the same venue, which was attended by over a thousand students. On Friday, the university, in its broader engagements in Chennai, hosted an industry networking session with industry leaders and CEOs of various companies.

“For NUS, engaging more deeply with India can broaden the questions we ask, challenge how we think about problems, and make our research more globally relevant and consequential,” acting dean of NUS Graduate School, Wong Lim Soon, said.

Timings CHENNAI

MONDAY, AUG. 31		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:21
RISE	20:28	SET 08:23
TUESDAY, SEP. 01		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:20
RISE	21:12	SET 09:17
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 02		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:19
RISE	22:00	SET 10:14

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	39	26
Chennai Airport	38	28
Chennai City	37	28

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36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. The night will be comfortable. There are chances of light rain and thundershowers at a few places.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
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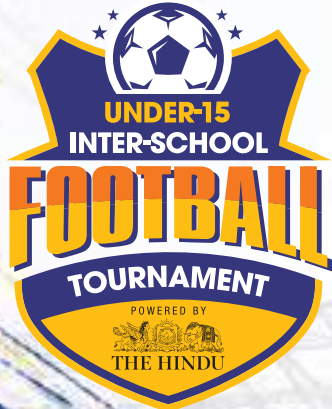
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M CH-CHE

3 members of family killed after autorickshaw hits parked truck

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Three persons of a family, including two women, were killed after an autorickshaw they were travelling in crashed into a truck near Periyapalayam of Tiruvallur district on Saturday night.

Loganathan, a resident of Kodungaiyur, was an autorickshaw driver. He, along with his family, had planned to go to the Periyapalayam temple on Saturday night.

His wife Poongodi, 39, daughter Dhanalakshmi, 10, mother-in-law Radha, 65, and his nephews Go-

The autorickshaw they were travelling in overturned after it hit the truck

kul, 10, and Prashanth, 15, were proceeding to the temple in the autorickshaw. While driving the autorickshaw at Panapakam, Loganathan did not see the truck parked near the bus stop and crashed into it.

The autorickshaw overturned in the impact, killing Poongodi on the spot. Residents of the locality rescued the five others who sustained severe inju-

ries, and they were rushed to the Periyapalayam Government Primary Health Centre.

Radha and Gokul died at the health centre.

Shifted to hospital

The Periyapalayam police shifted the remaining three injured persons Loganathan, Dhanalakshmi, and Prasanth, to the Tiruvallur Government Hospital for further treatment.

After registering a case, the Periyapalayam police recovered the bodies of the deceased and sent them to the Tiruvallur Government Hospital for post-mortem examination.

Youth dies as truck hits his two-wheeler

CHENNAI: A 18-year-old college student was killed after being knocked off his two-wheeler by a truck near Manali on Saturday.

The deceased was identified as Lokesh, a resident of Ponneri, and was a student at the CPCL private polytechnic college in Manali.

As Lokesh was returning home from the college on the Kosasthalai river bridge, a speeding truck knocked him down and sped away.

Lokesh was thrown off his vehicle. He sustained severe head injuries and died on the spot. A search is on for the truck driver.

THE HINDU

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SUSINANTH POTRI
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I, ANSHU Kumari daughter of Kamlesh Pandey, resident of Air Force Station Avadi, Tamilnadu- 600055 have changed my name from Anshu Kumari to Anshu Pandey vide affidavit No. FG 524250 dated 07 Aug 26 before V Ganesh Rao, Advocate Avadi, Chennai.

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Experts discuss ways to tackle myopia in children

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Greater awareness is needed to counter misinformation on social media and unproven products marketed for preventing or controlling myopia, experts said at a webinar organised by *The Hindu* on Sunday.

At the webinar titled ‘Excess Screenshot: Is it Harming Children’s Eyes?’, Vasumathy Vedantham, ophthalmologist, vitreoretinal surgeon and paediatric retina specialist, Radhatri Nethralaya, and Vasudha Kemmanur, consultant paediatric ophthalmologist and public eye health specialist, Narayana Nethralaya, dis-

cussed the growing concern over myopia and refractive errors among children.

Dr. Vedantham highlighted the need for parents to be cautious about health information circulating on social media. Dr. Kemmanur emphasised the importance of adequate time outdoors for children, noting that reduced outdoor exposure was a concern amid rising myopia.

The experts also discussed the importance of regular eye screening, recognising early signs of vision problems and seeking timely evaluation.

The session was moderated by Athira Elssa Johnson, Senior Reporter, *The Hindu*. The webinar can be viewed at newsth.live/ScreenTime

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4	03263392	BRAKE PIPE SUPPORT ANGLE AS PER DRAWING NO. S.E.C.RLY/SK NO. WRS/R-1667,Alt-4.	08.09.2026 At 10:30 hrs	57153 Nos.
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10	05265054	Underground Railway Signaling Cable Unscreened, PVC insulated, PVC inner sheathed, armoured and PVC outer jacket with high conductivity 'annealed copper conductor, Size-12 Core, x 1.5 Sq.mm conforming to R D S O Specification no. IRS/S- j63/2014, (Rev. 4.0) with latest amendment.	18.09.2026 At 10:30 hrs	7043 Kilometer

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EDUCATION PLUS

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Ponmythili Muralidharan

Degrees have become central to how we understand educational progress. Colleges are expanding, enrolments are growing, and more youngsters enter the workforce every year with certificates in hand. By that measure, we should be more educated than we have ever been.

Yet most of us would have met someone whose qualifications gave them real authority, but who used it to intimidate rather than to help. Someone who knew more than the person in front of them and made sure that person felt small for not knowing it.

We recognise this the moment we see it. We rarely stop to ask what it means. It means the qualification arrived, but something else did not.

Distinctions

That something else is education. It is not the same thing as literacy or certification. Literacy gives us access to knowledge. Certification records that we have completed a prescribed course of study. Education is different. It is supposed to change what we do with what we know. A person may be literate, highly qualified and professionally successful but use knowledge to set themselves apart from others or above them. An educated person uses the same knowledge with greater responsibility, humility



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Education or certification?

Why we need to differentiate between literacy, certification, and education

and awareness of others. This is not a small distinction. It decides what kind of society we are actually building.

I see this shift happen quietly, every year, in my own classroom. I once asked a class to discuss a case without telling them whether it would be assessed. The first question was not about the dilemma in the case. It was, “Ma’am, will this come for the exam?” It was an hon-

est and revealing question. Somewhere along the way, learning had become valuable only when it could be converted into marks.

This is why, over the years, I have tried to create more space for experience alongside assessment. A mark tells you what a student memorised for three hours. It does not tell you what changed in them. When learning is designed to be lived and not just re-

called, students stop asking, “What will be asked?” and start asking, “What does this mean?” That shift captures an important difference between literacy and education within a single classroom.

What is missing

But this is not only a story about individual students or individual professionals who lost their way. It is also a story about a system that has gradually evolved in

ways that often produce this outcome.

Schools and colleges under pressure to place students, to show results, to stay relevant in a competitive market, have increasingly prioritised the job at the end over the person being shaped along the way. Students are prepared to be employable. They are not always prepared to be transformed. That is not a small oversight. It shapes an entire

generation’s relationship with knowledge itself.

The growing interest in experiential and alternative forms of schooling may also reflect this unease. Many parents appear to be looking for learning environments that develop curiosity, independence, and social awareness alongside academic achievement. Whether or not these alternatives offer a complete answer, their appeal tells us something about what families feel is missing from conventional education.

So, perhaps, the more useful question for all of us is not whether our institutions are failing us. It is whether we know what we are actually asking of them. What are we asking for when we choose a school, a college, or a course? Are we asking to be made employable or to be transformed? Once we know the answer, what does that require of us as students, parents, teachers, and educational institutions?

We cannot place the responsibility for this only on the system or the individual. Both have a role in what gets built and both have a role in fixing it. The first step is simply to stop confusing the certificate with the change it was supposed to represent and to start asking, honestly, which one we have actually been given.

The writer is Junior Faculty Organisation - Behaviour and Human Resource at Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai.

SCHOLARSHIPS

JK Tyre Shiksha Sarthi Scholarship

An initiative by JK Tyre and Industries Ltd.

Eligibility: Students enrolled in general or professional UG or Diploma courses with 55% in the previous academic year and who are residents of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Karnataka, or Tamil Nadu and are daughters of heavy vehicle drivers and have an annual parental income not exceeding ₹500,000.

Rewards: Up to ₹25,000

Application: Online

Deadline: September 10

www.b4s.in/edge/JKTS4

IDFC FIRST Bank Engineering Scholarship

An initiative by IDFC FIRST Bank.

Eligibility: Students who are Indian citizens in the first year of a B.Tech or B.E. programme (2026-27)

academic year) in one of the FIRST IMPACT empanelled colleges and have an annual family income less than or equal to ₹600,000.

Rewards: ₹100,000 a year up to four years.

Application: Online

Deadline: September 20

www.b4s.in/edge/IFBES2

Mahindra EmpowerHer Scholarship

An initiative by Mahindra & Mahindra Limited.

Eligibility: Girl students from the SC, ST or OBC communities in school (Classes 9 to 12) or college (general UG or PG programmes) and have got at least 50% in the previous academic year or semester and have an annual family income should not exceed ₹400,000.

Rewards: ₹5,500

Application: Online

Deadline: September 21

<http://www.b4s.in/edge/MNM3>

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

Yuva Yodha

Schneider Electric has launched Yuva Yodha, a national tech hackathon to create innovative, practical, and scaleable solutions for India’s growing energy and sustainability need across four key areas critical to India’s growth and energy transition: Sustainable Agriculture, Smart

Buildings, Grid Reliability and Renewable Intermittency, and Smart Manufacturing

Eligibility: Indian citizens or residents who are full-time students of UG or PG STEM programmes. Participants can compete individually or in teams of up to four members.

Deadline: October 4

Details at yuvayodhatech.com

Residents complain of increase in height of relaid roads in city

A report documents height violations in 42 roads in city; says residents spend exorbitant amounts to elevate their ground floors to escape floods

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Residents have complained about height violations in 42 roads of Chennai and 203 stretches in other districts using GPS-tagged photographic evidence of an increase in height of newly laid roads.

Arappor Iyakkam, an anti-corruption watchdog, has compiled the list based on crowdsourced data containing 245 specific instances of road height violations across the State. Residents in C.P. Ramasamy Road, T.T.K. Road, Cenotaph Road, Ashok Nagar Eleventh Avenue, Besant Nagar First Main Road, AGS Colony Second Main Road, Mogappair West Main Road, Canal Bank Road, and R.A.Puram have complained about the issue.

Arappor Iyakkam con-



Elevated roads direct rainwater and sewage into low-lying houses. FILE PHOTO

vener Jayaram Venkatesan said: “In places like Mugali-vakkam, the houses have gone almost one to two feet below the road level. Chennai is one of the most affected. The report recommends systemic changes that the government should make immediately.”

“When the road is raised, the platform is at the same height as the road. Wasteful tenders are floated to raise platforms, manholes, and silt drains.

It also upsets stormwater drain networks as well,” said Mr. Venkatesan.

The crisis stems from contractors routinely bypassing the mandatory cold milling norms. Elevated roads direct rainwater and raw sewage directly into low-lying houses during monsoons. Homes affected now require stepping down, creating hazardous physical barriers for senior citizens and persons with disabilities. Unmilled roads result in dangerously sunken manholes and utility chambers, which frequently cause two-wheeler accidents.

Residents are forced to spend exorbitant amounts, sometimes as high as ₹40 lakh, to elevate their ground floors to escape flooding, the report said. The residents have also demanded financial compensation from the State government.

Madras, a place where women found home, and freedom, says Kalpana Karunakaran

Chennai/Madras means a great deal to me and the older generations of women in my family. I have just written a book on my maternal grandmother, and ‘Madras’ is in the title of the book!

For my grandmother, born in 1911, Madras meant the possibility of six precious years of school life. She studied at Lady Willingdon School on Marina Beach. And for my great-grandmother born in 1897, Madras was the city to which she escaped and where she lived apart from her husband, experiencing the relative freedom of city life and the heady atmosphere of the Freedom Movement for six years.

My mother, born in 1939, was an active organiser of factory workers and a familiar face and name during the massive May Day rallies that the city witnessed in the 1970s and 80s.



Kalpana Karunakaran is the author of *A Woman of No Consequence: Memory, Letters and Resistance in Madras*.

rector M.B. Srinivasan, along with hundreds of schoolkids on a busy road, somewhere sometime in 1984-85.

(As told to Meenakshy S.)



From the archives: K.B. Sundarambal during the recording of her Congress Jubilee songs on the gramophone. S. Sathyamurthi, Congress leader, is seen standing behind the main artiste. (Published in *The Hindu* on January 01, 1936). This photo and more are on display at *The Hindu* Made of Chennai Archival Photo Exhibit as part of Madras Month celebrations. The exhibition will be on at *The Hindu* office till September 14 and is open to the public from 10 a.m. to 6.30 p.m. on all days, except Sundays. To visit, register for free at <https://madeofchennai.thehindu.com/>



Former Governor Banwarilal Purohit presenting an award to Manik Sarkar, former Chief Minister of Tripura. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

NEP led to closure of nearly 1 lakh public schools: Manik Sarkar

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Ever since the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 was implemented, nearly one lakh public schools have closed down across the country, former Chief Minister of Tripura, Manik Sarkar, said on Saturday.

In his acceptance speech after receiving the Era. Sezhiyan Award conferred by the Navalar-Sezhiyan Trust at the Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT) in Chennai, Mr. Sarkar said that while public schools were shutting down, private ones were mushrooming, leaving students from the lower economic strata with no scope to pursue education. Similarly, in the health sector, private capital has been expanding while public investment has been shrinking, he said.

Quoting a NITI Aayog report of 2025, he said that the rate of unemployed graduates in India was 13% of the total population. He said NITI Aayog had observed that there was a

wide gap between the number of educated youth and the scope of jobs befitting their qualification.

G. Viswanathan, founder-Chancellor, VIT, said education goes a long way in improving the per capita income of individuals. He said VIT has supported about 1,200 rural students with free education and placement. He said the State and Union governments should spend more on education.

V.V. Swaminathan, former Minister and MP, who was conferred with the Dr. Navalar award, recalled his association with Navalar Nedunchezhiyan, Era Sezhiyan, and K. Anbazhagan in college that led to the formation of the Rationalist Youth Forum, which served as a precursor to the Dravidar Kazhagam student wing.

Banwarilal Purohit, former Governor of Assam, Tamil Nadu, and Punjab, said that while he was Governor of Tamil Nadu, he tried his best to improve State-run universities.

G.V. Selvam, vice-president, VIT, also spoke.

Residents seek heritage status for sacred grove in Agaramthen

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Residents and conservationists have sought protection for the four-acre sacred grove near Agaramthen wetland by declaring it a Biodiversity Heritage Site. Located about eight

km southeast of Tambaram Junction, the sacred grove is one of the few surviving sacred groves in the Greater Chennai region.

Revered as the abode of Kanni Amman, the grove also supports local communities, including the nearby Irula tribal settlement. A recent biodiversity survey recorded 222 species in the grove, including 102 plant species, 60 birds, 23 reptiles and amphibians, seven mammals, and 30 butterfly species.

The study was conducted independently by conservationists Thirumuru-

gan Vedagiri, a resident of Agaramthen, along with Patrisha, Krishnaveni, and Karthy, under the guidance of G. Gnanasekaran, assistant professor, Department of Botany, Madras Christian College, and Nehru Prabakaran of the Wildlife Institute of India.

“The grove is facing increasing pressure from vegetation clearing, garbage and plastic dumping, pollution, and habitat fragmentation. Surrounding agricultural and open lands are also increasingly being converted into plots, which puts further pres-

sure on the remaining green spaces,” said Mr. Vedagiri.

Researchers said the grove's biodiversity has not been comprehensively documented earlier and that the latest survey provides important information for conservation.

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Tamil Nadu

From Page One

Cong. will quit Cabinet if Rahul not accepted as PM candidate: Minister

Mr. Rajesh Kumar said the Congress was gaining popularity among the people from all walks of life as Mr. Rahul Gandhi was relentlessly fighting against the Narendra Modi-led BJP government at the Centre and its “anarchic, anti-people, and anti-youth policies.”

“If the TVK decides not to accept Mr. Rahul Gandhi as the prime ministerial candidate, the two Congress Ministers in the Tamil Nadu Cabinet will immediately resign from their posts,” he said, drawing applause from party cadre.

His warning comes against the backdrop of some TVK Ministers and functionaries seeking to project Mr. Vijay as a prime ministerial candidate.

INBRIEF



BJP condemns comments by TVK MLA against Amaran

BJP Tamil Nadu president Nainar Nagenthiran on Sunday objected to the comments of TVK MLA Madhar Badhurudeen, also known as V.M.S. Mustafa, on *Amaran*, a Tamil biopic on late army officer Major Mukund Varadarajan. In a social media post, he said: “If a movie is made on the truth about terrorists from Pakistan, how can it be considered as something that is against Muslims?” He urged TVK founder and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to reprimand Mr. Mustafa. Speaking to journalists in Madurai recently, the MLA had said Muslims were shown in a bad light in the 2024 blockbuster.

Several business houses in T.N. line up for the IPO route

Milky Mist and Lalithaa Jewellery already went public this year. Over the last 3 years, companies such as Avalon Technologies Ltd. and Dr. Agarwal's Healthcare Ltd., have joined the IPO market

Sangeetha Kandavel
CHENNAI

Several relatively newer Tamil Nadu-based business houses are shedding their conservative tag and knocking on the doors of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) to tap into the initial public offering (IPO) market. Milky Mist, headquartered in Erode, and Chennai-based Lalithaa Jewellery have already gone public this year and witnessed strong subscription.

A few more are expected to join the queue in the coming months.

Chennai-headquartered drone technology company Garuda Aerospace and a consumer durables company Sathya Agencies are also expected to join the IPO queue.

“Each year, around three to four companies from Tamil Nadu are getting listed,” said an analyst tracking the markets. Over the last three years, several Tamil Nadu-based companies including Avalon Technologies Ltd., R.K. Swamy Ltd., Northern Arc Capital Ltd., Dr. Agarwal's Healthcare Ltd., and Glottis Ltd., have tapped into the IPO market.

“The promoter-driven mindset is slowly changing. People have started realising that if I own 100% of the company, its value



Value boost: From left, Ashish Chauhan, MD and CEO, National Stock Exchange, with T. Satish Kumar, CMD, Milky Mist, and K. Rathnam, whole-time director and CEO, at the listing ceremony.

may be ₹100, but if I share at least 25% with the public, the company's value could rise to ₹500. “That kind of value creation was not known earlier,” said Nagappan Valliappan, a capital market professional, who was the former chairman of the Federation of Indian Stock Exchanges.

“If you look at family businesses in Tamil Nadu, many of them are now in their third or fourth generation. There are family disputes and divisions taking place. As a result, some businesses feel it is better to go public, and after a point, sell the company rather than deal with family tussles,” said a source who has been dealing with family businesses in Tamil Nadu.

Pranav Haldea, manag-



Each year, around three to four companies from Tamil Nadu are getting listed. The promoter-driven mindset is slowly changing

NAGAPPAN VALLIAPPAN
A capital market professional

ing director of Prime Database Group, said: “What you are seeing in Tamil Nadu is what I like to call the ‘net worth creation effect’. This has happened across India over the last five-six years. Class B/C towns and cities in India have been largely dominated by family-controlled and closely held businesses that were never too keen on getting

outside investors.”

Mr. Haldea said: “What happened was a few IPOs of such type of companies started happening and others saw the kind of valuation and net worth creation that can happen when value is unlocked through an IPO, with several of these promoters becoming millionaires or even billionaires. This triggered a sense of FOMO (fear of missing out) among other family-owned businesses.”

According to data shared by Prime Database, a provider of information on capital markets, 2023 saw 57 issues across India, raising ₹49,436 crore. In 2024, the number increased to 91 issues, raising ₹1,59,784 crore. The momentum continued in 2025, with 103 issues raising ₹1,75,914 crore. In the current year (2026), the numbers stand at 61 issues, raising ₹72,283 crore.

Those who have gone public through an IPO said that it made them more disciplined and accountable. “You are constantly tracked and are answerable to your shareholders. The capital gives us the ability to invest in the next phase of growth, but equally important is the discipline that comes with being a public company,” said K. Rathnam, whole-time director and chief executive officer, Milky Mist Dairy Food.

Woman’s murder: couple arrested in Manipur being brought to Chennai

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Nearly a month after a woman was murdered in Chennai and her dismembered body parts were found inside an abandoned trolley bag on board the Tamil Nadu Express at Agra Cantonment, the Guduvanchery police have arrested a couple from Manipur in the case.

The arrested – Manik Uddin Laskar and Bhagabati Majhi – are being brought to Chennai after obtaining a prisoner of transit warrant from the judicial magistrate of Jirbham district in the north-eastern State. A senior officer of the Tambaram Police Commissionerate said the team was expected to reach Chennai on Sunday night.

The police had arrested the couple on Saturday in connection with the murder of a 38-year-old woman in Guduvanchery, whose decomposed and dismembered body parts were found stuffed inside a trolley bag aboard the Chennai-New Delhi Tamil Nadu Express at Agra earlier this month. While Laskar hails from Dakshin Krishnapur, Sonabarighat, in Assam's Cachar district his wife Bhagabati Majhi is from Odisha.

The murder came to light on August 5, when the

body was found in the rear general compartment of the Tamil Nadu Express in Agra. The Agra Railway Police launched an investigation.

After being informed, the Government Railway Police at the Chennai Central railway station and the Railway Protection Force examined CCTV footage from Platform 4 and spotted a man and a woman carrying a suspicious trolley bag and boarding the train. Their movements led investigators to Guduvanchery, where they identified a rented house on Ma-suthi Street in which the couple had allegedly been staying with another woman. The deceased was later identified as Hayathun Nisha, 38, wife of Jahhur Khan and a native of Jagat-singhpur in Odisha. She stayed in Guduvanchery and worked at a private firm.

The police found Laskar and Bhagabati had gone missing. Tambaram City Police Commissioner Prem Anand Sinha formed a special team to trace the suspects. A senior police officer said the team travelled to a remote and difficult-to-access area of Manipur in search of Laskar. The police said the motive for the murder would be established only after the couple was brought to Tambaram and questioned.

The Hindu In School Educators’ Confluence 2026 on Sept. 2

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Hindu In School Educators’ Confluence 2026 will be held on September 2 at Hyatt Regency in Chennai at 10 a.m. The confluence will serve as a platform for school leaders, educators, and academic visionaries to exchange ideas and explore the changing contours of education.

Organised by *The Hindu In School*, the theme of this Educators’ Confluence is ‘The New School of Thought: Rethinking Learning. Reimagining Leadership.’

Shaping a New Generation reflects the urgent



need to reassess traditional approaches to education in a rapidly transforming world.

Founder of SNEHA and Head of the Department of Psychiatry, Voluntary Health Services (VHS), Lakshmi Vijayakumar, will speak on ‘The Digital Child: Are We Losing Attention, Connection and Curiosity?’, where she will explore how educators and parents can work to-

gether to create healthier learning ecosystems.

AI-assisted learning

Founder and CEO of CEN-TA (Centre for Teacher Accreditation), Ramya Venkataraman, will speak on the topic ‘Teacher of Tomorrow: Empowering Educators in the Age of AI’, where she will discuss how educators can leverage AI-powered tools to enhance teaching effectiveness.

Attendance is by invitation only. The strategic partner is Blue Scorp, travel partner is The Global Travel Experts and the gift sponsor is Meru Consulting. For further information, please contact N. Hariharan +91 97890 69672.

Van mows down four children in Dindigul

The Hindu Bureau
DINDIGUL

Four children, including two sisters, were run over by a van near Vadamadurai in Dindigul district on Sunday.

The police said Anjam-mal, 60, of Kanavaimedu near the Kollapatti Samathuvapuram, was grazing her goats near the national highway. Four of her relatives’ children were playing nearby on the roadside. A van ran over the children, who died on the spot. The van driver then fled the spot. The police identified the children as Yogavarshini, 11, daughter of Nagaraj, and her younger sister, Ananya, 6; Dha-

nusri, 5, daughter of Jagadeesan; and Mosikaran, 6, son of Chinnathambi. Anjammal fainted in the aftermath of the accident, and was rushed to a primary health centre, they said. The bodies were sent to the Government Medical College and Hospital, Dindigul.

The Vadamadurai police registered a case, nabbed the driver, and seized the vehicle. Investigations suggested that the driver, identified as Saravana Kumar of Kurunthampatti near Ayalur was driving rashly and lost control of the vehicle, causing the accident. His confession was recorded, the police added. Further investigation is on.

The Banyan Academy launches Dr. Parasuraman writing award

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Banyan Academy of Leadership in Mental Health, The Banyan, and Aaldamara Foundation has launched the Dr. Parasuraman Lived Experience Writing Award, and two writers who are service users of mental healthcare were presented with the award.

Former judge of Madras High Court and writer Justice Prabha Sridevan presented the awards to Sunitha Shirly, a social entrepreneur, lyricist, musician and author, and Sasisekar Menon, a librarian, according to a press release. The award has been



Justice Prabha Sridevan presenting the award to Sunitha Shirly in Chennai on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

instituted in memory of the former director of Tata Institute of Social Sciences, who championed transformative higher education to fight deprivation and inequity. “To create the space and support for such stories, this award is being

instituted to support writing from the vantage of intimate interiority with madness, populated over time with all the diversity of minds in our country,” a press release said.

While Ms. Shirly is the founder of Root Trust and has authored over 18 books, from novels, short stories, and poetry to essays and even science books for children, Mr. Menon was already a Disability Awardee on Republic Day 2026 and has lived with Schizophrenia and Parkinson's. Both awardees will have a mentor and editor to assist them in writing their books and telling stories of distress and resilience.

‘External intelligence agency, bureau are first arm of offence and defence’

Udhav Naig
CHENNAI

Former secretary of the Research and Analysis Wing (R&AW) Vikram Sood said on Saturday that the external intelligence agency and the Intelligence Bureau had to work together as they form India's first arm of offence and defence respectively.

Speaking in Chennai at an event organised by Chennai International Centre and Deccan Centre for International Affairs on the topic ‘Covert Wars and Great Power Games’, Mr. Sood, in a conversation with C. Balasubramanian, senior advisor, Deccan Centre for International Affairs, said: “The external intelligence (agency) is the first arm of offence and the Intelligence Bureau is the first arm of your defence in



Vikram Sood, former Secretary, R&AW, and C. Balasubramanian, senior advisor, Deccan Centre for International Affairs, in conversation at an event in Chennai on Saturday. M. SRINATH

geopolitics. The two have to work together. That apart, the world is spinning so fast, and the events are happening so fast...its quality, its depth, disinformation...all that is being thrown at your table, and I am sure our men have found ways of going around them.”

Mr. Sood, who is the author of *The Unending Game: A Former R&AW Chief's Insights Into Espion-*

age, The Ultimate Goal: A Former R&AW Chief Deconstructs How Nations Construct Narratives, and Great Power Games: From Western Decline to Eastern Ascent, said the U.S. believed that they could finish the job in Iran in a matter of days. “But the Iranians have been preparing, they knew this is going to happen, and after what they did in the Balkans in the nineties, after what

they did to Iraq (George Bush's time), they knew that this is going to be a ruthless attack on them,” he said.

On what Pakistan could do, Mr. Sood said they might be planning another attack, but the Saudis and the Turks won't get involved in the conflict.

“This is a local tie-up in the Middle East to keep Iran down....to tell Donald Trump that we are going to look after our own security, and we don't want to buy anything from you,” he said.

Mr. Sood added: “To say that America [the U.S.] has always fought for democracies is wrong. They have not. They have fought for national interests. And at one stage, they had 66 autocratic countries supporting them and fighting for democracy.”

Tributes paid to Moopanar on his 25th death anniversary

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Political leaders from across various parties, including the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, Congress, MDMK, CPI(M), and CPI, paid respects to late Congress stalwart and Tamil Maanila Congress (TMC) founder G.K. Moopanar on his 25th death anniversary at his memorial in Chennai on Sunday.

Participating in the event in the presence of TMC (Moopanar) leader G.K. Vasan, Tamil Nadu Fisheries Minister A. Srinath said: “Just as how the TVK is striving to create a Tamil Nadu without bribery, Moopanar followed Kamarajar Ayya in his path, working for the people and not going after positions.”

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) presi-



TMC (Moopanar) president G.K. Vasan paying homage to his father at the latter's memorial in Chennai on Sunday. R. RAGU

dent B. Manickam Tagore said: “One of [former Prime Minister] Rajiv Gandhi's dreams was to bring back Kamarajar's rule in Tamil Nadu under the leadership of Moopanar. When I asked Madam (Sonia Gandhi) how she remembers Moopanar, she

replied, ‘He was one of those brave leaders who prevented communal forces from coming to power’. He was an identity for many of us,” he said.

MDMK chief Vaiko recalled his association with Moopanar as an MP in New Delhi.

Rally planned on Sept. 11 to protest govt.'s usage of ‘Adi Dravidar’

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

Puthiya Tamilagam founder K. Krishnasamy on Sunday announced a protest rally in Paramakudi on September 11 to condemn the Tamil Nadu government's continued use of the term ‘Adi Dravidar’.

Addressing reporters in Madurai, Mr. Krishnasamy said although the department had been officially renamed as Social Welfare Department, Minister Vani Arasu still relied on the older reference

“After fighting hard to have our community recognised as Devendra Kula Vellalars, we are being overshadowed by the ‘Adi Dravidar’ label,” Mr. Krishnasamy added.



Palliyodams, the traditional snake boats of Kerala, glide along the Pampa during a regatta in Aranmula on Sunday. LEJU KAMAL

Aranmula boat race a symbol of Keralam’s rich culture, says V-P

The Hindu Bureau
KOLLAM

The Aranmula Uthrattathi boat race stands as a timeless symbol of Keralam’s rich cultural heritage, deep devotion, and enduring traditions, Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan said while inaugurating the event at Aranmula in Pathanamthitta district on Sunday.

He added that the town itself is named after the ancient Parthasarathy temple, which boasts a heritage spanning nearly 1,800 years, and is equally famed as the birthplace of the Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged Aranmula *Kannadi* (metal mirror). Stressing the importance of safeguarding cultural legacies, the Vice-President pointed out the vital need to preserve and promote traditional arts and crafts.

He praised the majestic, beautifully decorated *Palliyodams* powered by over a hundred oarsmen rowing in complete unison, serv-

ing as a masterclass in physical endurance and extraordinary craftsmanship. He remarked that the Aranmula boat race has captivated visitors from across India and around the globe for centuries, securing a prominent place for Aranmula on the cultural and tourism map – a legacy that must be carefully preserved for future generations.

Festivals, he observed, serve as a poignant reminder of the remarkable power of heritage to unite people and fortify social bonds. He pointed out that tradition and modernity are not conflicting forces, but rather pillars that can comfortably coexist. He added that while Keralam celebrates Onam, Odisha observes the Rath Yatra in Puri. He observed that a shared culture consistently binds the nation together. He also expressed his deep delight at having presided over the Rajya Sabha session during which the Bill to rename the State as “Keralam” was passed.

T.N. moves SC, seeks release of Cauvery water backlog

Karnataka must release balance quantity of 17604 tmc ft of water, T.N. tells top court; highlights plight of Cauvery Delta farmers; says CWRC and CWMA failed to consider accumulated backlog

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Tamil Nadu government approached the Supreme Court on Sunday, seeking a direction to Karnataka to release 17,604 tmc ft of water from the Cauvery river, the balance quantity as on August 27, based on the *pro-rata* formula.

The State, in a supplementary affidavit settled by senior advocate G. Umapathy and re-settled by C.S. Vaidyanathan, also urged the court to order Karnataka to release 9,000 cusecs of water between August 26 and September 8, as di-



The exposed rocky bed of the Cauvery at Hogenakkal in Tamil Nadu earlier this month. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

rected by the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA).

It further sought the top court’s intervention to direct Karnataka to make good the shortfall between the flows ensured at Billigundulu, a riverside village on the border between the two States, and the flows

that the CWMA had directed to take place between August 27 and August 30.

“The farmers of Cauvery Delta are seriously prejudiced as Kuruvai season is almost over and Mettur (dam) could not be open for irrigation,” Tamil Nadu submitted in the affidavit. A Bench is scheduled to

hear the Cauvery case on August 31.

Tamil Nadu said that CWRC had fixed 9,000 cusecs for the next 15 days with effect from August 25, without considering the accumulated backlog of 17,415 tmc as on August 23.

Tamil Nadu said it had raised its grievance before the CWMA, at its meeting the very next day on August 25, about the “gross inadequacy” of the CWRC order for release of water.

“CWMA mechanically affirmed the recommendation of CWRC and directed Karnataka to ensure only 9,000 cusecs per day from August 25 to September 8,” the affidavit said.

HC name to stay, despite Kerala becoming Keralam

K.S. Sudhi
KOCHI

The name High Court of Kerala (HCK) would stay despite the name of the State changing from “Kerala” to “Keralam”.

Keralam’s Chief Secretary had on Saturday issued a road map to rename government institutions after the Union government notified the name change.

Now, “Kerala” has to be renamed “Keralam” in millions of official records, documents, seals, publica-

tions, covers, letterheads, files and registers.

However, the changes will leave no impact on the High Court in the State. The name of the High Court can be changed only through a High Court Name Amendment Act to be passed by Parliament.

Needs legal procedure

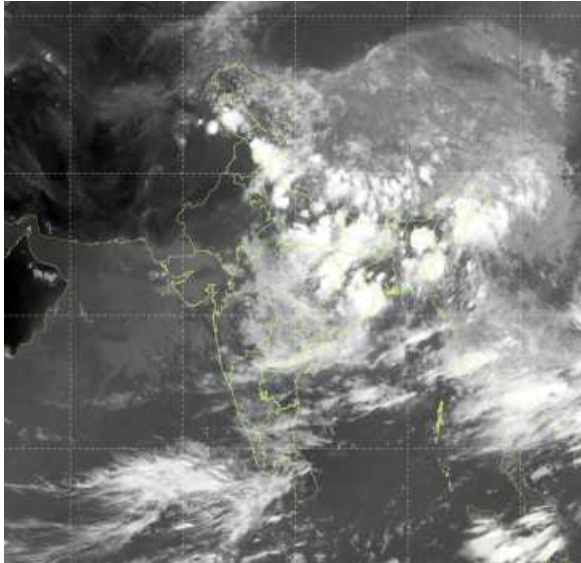
The amendment process has to be initiated by Parliament on a recommendation by the State executive and after ascertaining the views of the State judiciary,

said a senior judge of the High Court. Moreover, the judiciary is not part of the State government and has an independent footing.

The name changes introduced by the State government need not reflect on the name or character of the High Court. The judge also pointed out the instances of High Courts of Bombay, Calcutta, Madras and Orissa where the original names of the courts were retained despite the changes in the names of the respective States.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Monday: Heavy to very heavy rainfall likely in Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura and Uttarakhand. Thunderstorm with lightning and gusty winds likely in Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, Odisha, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal.

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		34.5	26.0	Kurnool		32.4	25.7
Ahmedabad		33.9	26.8	Lucknow		8.8	32.7
Aizawl		13.8	31.7	Madurai		40.0	24.6
Bengaluru		1.0	29.6	Mangaluru		10.4	29.7
Bhopal		27.4	23.2	Mumbai		3.0	32.4
Bhubaneswar		15.0	27.6	Mysuru			19.6
Chandigarh		35.8	26.6	New Delhi		35.2	27.2
Chennai		2.0	37.1	Patna		0.4	35.6
Coimbatore		33.0	22.0	Port Blair		3.7	30.3
Dehradun		18.0	25.4	Prayagraj		6.0	30.4
Gangtok		51.0	23.6	Puducherry		1.5	36.1
Goa		49.4	31.2	Pune		2.0	30.0
Guwahati		36.8	27.5	Raipur		16.2	24.8
Hubballi		27.0	21.0	Ranchi		53.0	29.6
Hyderabad		1.2	27.8	Shillong		25.0	28.3
Imphal		30.6	23.1	Shimla		24.5	18.3
Jaipur		34.0	25.8	Srinagar			33.4
Kochi		5.8	30.8	Thiruvananthapuram		30.3	24.9
Kohima		27.7	19.4	Tiruchirappalli		38.9	27.0
Kolkata		8.0	33.0	Vijayawada		34.4	28.5
Kozhikode		2.4	33.5	Visakhapatnam		34.1	29.4

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		24	37	5	31		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Charkhi Dabri,
Bengaluru		21	17	34	93		Haryana recorded an
Chennai			12		63		overall air quality index
Delhi		37	54	45	361		(AQI) score of 106
Hyderabad		13	12	38	48		indicating an unhealthy
Kolkata		5	30	37	43		level of pollution. In
Lucknow		9	19	95	25		contrast, Karwar,
Mumbai		5	8	20	24		Karnataka recorded a
Pune		17	13	66	24		healthy AQI score of 14.
Visakhapatnam		12	66	9	40		

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease.

After three decades, Naidu to inaugurate Veligonda project

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu will inaugurate the first phase of the Poola Subbaiah Veligonda irrigation project in Markapuram district on Monday.

Mr. Naidu laid the foundation stone for the project on March 5, 1996, as the Chief Minister of undivided Andhra Pradesh. The pro-

ject will bring relief to the drought-prone areas of Markapuram, Prakasam, Nellore and Kadapa districts. The government is organising the inauguration ceremony under the theme – *Velugonda Jala Sirulu – Abhivruddhiki Rekaku* (Velugonda Waters – Wings for Development).

For decades, the region has faced inadequate rainfall, depleted groundwater, fluoride contamination,

and a shortage of irrigation water. Once fully operational, the project will serve 30 mandals across the Prakasam, Markapuram, Nellore, and Kadapa districts, providing irrigation for 4.47 lakh acres and drinking water for 23 lakh people. The project diverts Krishna river water from the Srisaillam reservoir, stores it in the Nallamala Sagar, and distributes it through main canals.

KPSC ‘scam’: CID arrests Gangwar

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Criminal Investigation Department of the Karnataka Police on Saturday arrested IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar in connection with the alleged irregularities in the recruitment of 400 veterinary officers. He is the first accused to be arrested in the case.

Mr. Gangwar, who

served as Controller of Examinations at the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) from February 2024 to March 2026, was taken into custody after two days of questioning.

The IAS officer is scheduled to be produced before a magistrate, following which the CID is expected to seek his custody for further interrogation. More arrests are expected as the probe progresses.

4 attempts for MBBS cover supplementary exams: High Court

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

Both regular and supplementary examinations count towards the “four attempts within four years” rule for clearing the First Professional MBBS Degree examination, the Kerala High Court recently held.

Justice Bechu Kurian Thomas found that a candidate could avail of only four attempts, whether regular or supplementary exams, and no further opportunity could be granted once those attempts had been exhausted.

This was evident from the Graduate Medical Education Regulation, 2023, and the guidelines prescribed by the National Medical Commission (NMC), the court stated.

The court said regulations framed by academic bodies should not be subjected to casual judicial interference, especially when the issue concerned medical students, whose



Kerala High Court

competence affects public health and safety.

The petitioner contended that the four attempts prescribed in the rules must be interpreted as regular exams and should not include supplementary exams. She had not cleared the course, having failed in three subjects and used up all four attempts.

She had sought directions to write the next First Professional MBBS Degree examination, either as a mercy chance or as a chance available to her within the four years.

In Partnership with
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CASAGRANT
building aspirations

Presents
Made Of Chennai PHOTO QUIZ

THE HINDU GROUP
Co-powered by
THE HINDU

This still features Manorama, Nagesh and Sowcar Janaki from the 1968 Tamil film Edhir Neechal. Who directed the film, adapting his own stage play for the screen?

Answer to yesterday's Photo quiz:
Flight No. 172

Yesterday's winners:

1. Mala Venkatakrishnan
2. Sarasvathi Swaminathan
3. P A Raziya

Scan QR code or visit newsth.live/MOC2026PA to take the Photo quiz. Top 3 winners* every day win gift vouchers.

*T&C apply.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

SAD DEMISE

With profound grief, we inform you of the sad demise of our beloved father,
Mr. Kanchi. N. Selvaraj
Retd. Sr. B.M., Vice Principal, STC LIC who has attained Vaikunta Pathavi on 26.08.2026

In accordance with his wishes and spirit of selfless service, his body and eyes have been donated to **SRMC Hospital, Porur** for medical research and the gift of sight. The final rites will be held at **SRMC Hospital, Chennai - 600116** on 31.08.2026 at 12.00 noon.

Deeply Mourned by
Family Members

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

Coral (35)
Death Anniversary

Dr. A. N. Verghese (Ani)
Azhikkakathu Aiyroor
31.08.1991

Remembering with unceasing affection, the superior, sacrificial, selfless acts of love of our beloved brother.

Hoping to meet again on the God-appointed day.

Unni & family;
Praveen & Thampi;
Nena & family;
Ms. A. Thomas & family;
Saji, Reji, Viji & family

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

12th ANNIVERSARY

Dr. C.A. PERUMAL
(Emeritus Professor Of Politics & Public Administration, University of Madras)
31st August 2014
"YOU LIVE IN OUR MEMORY FOREVER"
Members Of The Family Of
Dr. C.A. Perumal
Ct: 9176678778

4th Death Anniversary

B. GANGA DEVI
DOB: 14.08.1948 - DOD: 31.08.2022
We miss you every moment in our life, your presence continues to surround us, in our hearts, you are always there.
Fondly Remembered by:
Family & Friends
Mob: 9884045571

BIRTH CENTENARY

In Memory of our dear mother
Smt. Rajalakshmi Rangaswamy (Abbi) & celebration of
100 years of her life
1926 - 2026

Our loving mother who nurtured us throughout her life.

Nagalakshmi Satyan
Choodamani Anand
Shantha Rangaswamy
Padma Sundareshan
Harini Sreekanth
Hemamalini Sridhar

Her Daughters
Sons-in-law
Grandkids
Great Grandkids

DEATH

In Loving Memory

Shri S. Venkataraman
(1950 - 2026)
Retired DGM, CPPD, IOB

With deep sorrow, we announce the passing of
Shri S. Venkataraman
on 29th August 2026, in Chennai.
He will be fondly remembered and deeply missed by his family and loved ones.



State of exception

India must not normalise a culture of discrimination

In its first review by the U.N. Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (CERD) since 2007, India has elicited an expression of “grave concern” about reports of the law enforcement apparatus resorting to violence – physical and otherwise – against minority ethnic and ethno-religious groups, Dalits, and non-citizens over the years. The Committee also noted that India, which ratified the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination in 1968, has not provided detailed and updated information about the state’s inquiries and sanctions arising from allegations of such violence. While the government has told CERD that caste bias falls outside Article 1 of the convention because caste is not synonymous with race, CERD has allowed all forms of discrimination based on inherited status. The Committee’s concerns also span the practice of manual cleaning of sewers despite a law banning it; hate speech against, poor living conditions of, and the mass refolement of Rohingya Muslims; the mass deprivation of citizenship via the National Register of Citizens; large-scale deletions from the Special Intensive Revisions of electoral rolls; the government’s use of the FCRA, UAPA, AFSPA, and PMLA instruments to hamper the work of civil society organisations; the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita not expressly criminalising racist hate speech; and the Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act exempting “national security” projects from consultative decision-making.

Given these issues and the fragmented recourse available, the lack of suitably disaggregated data on disenfranchised communities, including due to a much-delayed Census and the slow release of NCRB data, has transcended the bounds of administrative lethargy to actively impeding independent checks of India’s claims about fighting caste- and faith-based discrimination. In fact, India has been implementing “special measures” based on 2011 Census data, which could mask a regression in the socioeconomic status of Scheduled Tribes and Adivasis. Together with the Global Alliance of National Human Rights Institutions recommending the downgrade of the NHRC last year, following the government appointing police officers to investigative roles and a lack of pluralism, CERD is effectively stepping into a vacuum. The road ahead remains clear, from restoring the NHRC’s independence and criminalising hate speech to supportive affirmative action, collecting and publishing disaggregated data, and improving the transparency of the electoral roll revisions, and strengthening enforcement overall. But if the government’s attempted use of a technicality to keep the issues of 200 million Dalits a “domestic matter” and avoid international accountability – and its dismissal of CERD’s concerns as politically motivated – is any guide, the task continues to fall to civil society to exert influence in multilateral fora and sustain political, legal, and administrative resistance to government choices that normalise India’s sadly widespread culture of discrimination of all sorts.

Drawn to defeat

India is now in a must-win situation in the Test Championship cycle

This was a triumph that ironically suffered the after-effects of a loss. India’s 1-0 series victory in the two-Test outing recently in Sri Lanka, in normal circumstances, would have been seen as a positive. However, in the race for key points in the ICC World Test Championship (WTC) cycle, the ideal India-centric result would have been a clean sweep at 2-0. But with Dhananjaya de Silva’s men thwarting India’s bid for a win in the second Test at Colombo’s Sinhalese Sports Club Ground, and forcing a draw, the visitors continue to occupy the fifth slot in the WTC rankings. It is a position one below Bangladesh after the eastern neighbour secured a 1-1 draw against Australia in the series Down Under. If a WTC final berth has to be secured then India has to do extremely well away against New Zealand and at home against Australia, and then hope that the various permutations cropping up will be favourable. Shubman Gill’s men find themselves in this piquant situation due to their vulnerability at home, having lost a Test series to South Africa last year. The transition angst within the Indian unit is yet to abate following the exit of R. Ashwin, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma. Slowly, new heroes are emerging and the results could improve.

Stepping into the Emerald Isle and hamstrung by the injured Jasprit Bumrah’s absence, India did its homework. A warm-up fixture was won, while some of its players had earlier turned out for India A against Sri Lanka A and were ready. When the series commenced with the first Test at picturesque Galle, India led from the front and won by 165 runs to secure a 1-0 lead. Devdutt Padikkal’s 167 and 44 led the run charts and most importantly it also meant that the critical number three spot in the batting order had found an apt occupant for now. This is the same position that in the past had featured pedigreed men such as Dilip Vengsarkar, Rahul Dravid and Cheteshwar Pujara. Left-arm spinner Manav Suthar too did well and his classical mode is a throwback to a gentle past. Sri Lanka’s brief resistance hinged on Sonal Dinusha, who registered a ton. Soon he would become an immovable personality at the batting crease and India learnt it the hard way at Colombo. His twin hundreds helped Sri Lanka erase the ignominy of suffering a follow-on and also survive a tense final day to wrest a draw. The conclusion felt like a victory for the host and India is now placed in a must-win corner in its future Tests.

In his Independence day address this year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi declared that his government had eliminated the threat of armed Naxals/Maoists, but added that ‘*dimaagi*’ Naxals (brainy Naxals) remain. These dangerous individuals, he said, had been elevated to policy advisers by his predecessors. Now, they look for opportunities to ‘drag society onto the wrong path’ and ‘steer the nation’s youth’ away from the ‘mainstream effort’ to turn India into ‘a developed nation.’ He asked Indian citizens to ‘identify and isolate’ such individuals among them.

Defining the enemy

Is Mr. Modi the first leader of a democratic nation to declare thoughts to be crimes, without resort to innuendo or euphemism, in a formal address to the nation? A search for other instances came up empty.

But has he not used terms such as ‘urban Naxal’ before? Is ‘*dimaagi*’ Naxal’ any different? I believe it is a significant escalation.

First, while he has used the term ‘urban Naxal’ in campaign speeches and in Parliament, he has not previously used it in an Independence Day address to the nation.

Second, ‘urban’ implies an alleged connection to ‘rural’ Naxals: urban individuals are alleged to be facilitating crimes attributed to Maoist insurgents. The actual charges may be fabricated, and individuals might in fact be criminalised for their ideology, that is, for thought crimes. But the government did not admit this. In this case however, Mr. Modi declared the end of rural Naxals, and then formulated the category of ‘*dimaagi*’ Naxals’. It is their ‘*dimaag*’ alone, cut off from any alleged ties to armed Maoist insurgents, that he declares to be criminal.

Had Mr Modi chosen to say ‘Naxali *dimaag*’ or ‘Naxali *soch*’ (thinking), it might be taken to mean Maoist ideology. But ‘*dimaagi*’ Naxal’ does not identify a specific ideology as dangerous.

‘*Dimaag*’ itself is the deadly weapon. In Hindi/Urdu, *dimaag* is used to mean the brain, head, mind, consciousness, intellect, and intelligence. To use your *dimaag* is to ‘use your head’ – that is, to think out of the box, to reason, to think critically, to use your intelligence for resourceful problem-solving.

Mr. Modi is notorious for asking Indians to identify terrorists by what they wear - ‘*kapde se pehchano*’ (Identify/judge someone by their clothes) - a dog whistle for Muslims wearing lungis, skullcaps or hijabs. Now, he is saying ‘*dimaag se pehchano*’ – identify anti-nationals by how they think.

Operation Demonise *Dimaag* began a decade



Kavita Krishnan

Author of
‘De-democratisation,
A Global Story: Script,
Actors, Enablers’

ago in 2016, with the attempt to incite hatred and violence against Jawaharlal Nehru University students and teachers. For six years the regime has declared student protesters (such as Umar Khalid, Sharjeel Imam, Gulfisha Fatima, Natasha Narwal, Devangana Kalita) to be terrorists, without a trial, without much push-back from the judiciary and the press. Emboldened, it deployed the same tactic against students protesting examination paper leaks, calling them ‘*dehshatgarh*’ (terrorists). But stretched to such lengths, this tactic snapped – and backfired. It ‘leaked’ the key to the regime’s propaganda codes. All of a sudden, all too many people could see the pattern plainly. The government rewarded mindless obedience, reverence and adulation for Power. Apply your mind, your *dimaag*, to demand democratic accountability from Power, and it would “identify and isolate” you as a terrorist, an *andolanjevi* (parasite feeding on protests), a cockroach.

Echoes of an old template

The timing is telling. Mr Modi is attacking *Dimaag* when he is still smarting from his debacle at the hands of young students armed only with wit and imagination. He wants to prevent a recurrence. Ironically, since he calls his critics ‘Naxals’ (Maoists), he seems to be embracing the Chinese template for thought crimes.

A Chinese Communist Party memorandum, of 2013, warns that Internet forums, “lectures, seminars, university classrooms, class discussion forums, civilian study groups” as well as “open letters and... petition-signings to vocalise requests for political reforms, improvement of human rights” represent a threat to the nation. Why? Because “if we allow any of these ideas to spread, they will disturb people’s existing consensus on important issues like which flag to raise, which road to take, which goals to pursue”.

That is what the student protests did: demolish Mr. Modi’s claim to represent a monolithic popular consensus, challenged only by a tiny gang of unpopular critics. That consensus must be restored.

Mr. Modi identified ‘*dimaagi*’ Naxals’ as the foremost internal threat to national security. Is his plan for “a huge voluntary force of civil defence” intended to deal with them?

The examples Mr. Modi cites are unconvincing. Defending refineries from aerial bombardment and banks from cyber attacks cannot be left to ‘civilian volunteers’ – these would need enhanced air defence and cyber-security systems comprising experts. We already have the Civil Defence Act 1968 and the Home Guards to organise civilians for non-combat roles. Is Mr.

The new
labelling is an
escalation of
the
government’s
attitude
towards dissent
and democracy

Nepal’s agony, the Himalayan warning to India

Will India learn now at least? Will it let Nepal speak to India through its agony what India has refused to hear?

The Himalaya are not a series of silos – Afghanistan Hindu Kush Himalaya, Pakistan Himalaya, Indian Himalaya, Nepal Himalaya, the Himalaya in Tibet-China, Bhutan. To employ a powerful term I have heard Vadodara-based painter Gulam Mohammed Sheikh use for the Elephanta Caves, the Himalaya are one living rock, silently, broodingly, tense with seismic voltages, glacial stirrings and geological turbulence.

And they spell their uncoded thought in swipes no one can foretell. When, where exactly, with what ferocity, no one knows. And what disasters may radiate from them – through rivers plucked from their courses, rockfalls and landslides depositing mud and silt, turning human habitations into rubble and fertile farms into slime – no one can precisely envision.

Ask those who have heard from their parents and grandparents of the Nepal-Bihar earthquake of 1934 or the Assam temblor of 1950. They will speak of the nightmare.

The question of preparedness

The world has been told – India has specifically been warned – by seismologists of an impending earthquake of humungous scale with the potential of a cataclysm across a great swathe of northern India which lies under the quake-shadow of the Himalaya. It is not as if India’s government has declined to heed the warning. It has done much, as its disaster management agencies will rightly assure us, to be alert to the risk.

But after 26/8 what we need to ask and know is: should what happened in upper Nepal have



Gopalkrishna Gandhi

Former administrator
who has held
diplomatic and
constitutional offices

happened in lower Nepal, and even lower than that, would our ‘preparedness’ have sufficed to save riverside habitations from instant death?

More pertinently, we need to ask and know whether the absolutely fearsome phenomenon of global warming triggered GLOFs (or Glacial Lake Outburst Floods), has led authorities to warn people living in potential GLOF-affected areas in India of the danger they face and advised them on how to face it.

We are, let us face it, in seismic, glacial, climatological and geological innocence.

By ‘we’ I mean we the people of India. Our earth scientists know it all but their *jnana* is clasped tight in their *acharya-mushiti-s* (‘knowledge kept in the teacher’s fist’).

What happened in Nepal on that stricken Wednesday is yet to be fully appraised. We will soon enough know whether it was an earthquake that caused the GLOF, or whether the GLOF resulted in the earth quaking and waterbodies swelling as they never have before.

Whatever happened, India must learn

Be the sequence as it may, the following lessons scream to be learnt by India.

First, the Himalaya, held sacred since memory has served, gestate ‘sure-shot’ danger.

Second, these dangers can now no longer be left to be unravelled in seminars and technical papers.

Third, they have to be made known on a war footing to us, the clear potential victims.

Fourth, and not just made known as in increasing our knowledge but made known as in making us part of a new safeguarding.

Fifth, our scholar-diplomat Shyam Saran has, in two timely and telling articles in *The Tribune* (“China’s hydel project bodes ill for India”, July 14, 2026) and *The Indian Express* (“From Nepal to

Modi’s proposal inspired by his ideological gurus from a century ago?

In 1931, Dr. B.S. Moonje, Hindu Mahasabha leader and close associate of Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) founder K.B. Hedgewar, visited Italy to meet the fascist leader Benito Mussolini. Mussolini was notorious for civilian militias such as the ‘Voluntary Militia for National Security’, colloquially known as the Blackshirts, which unleashed violent terror against political rivals, union leaders, journalists and writers. In 1934, Moonje and Hedgewar met to discuss the need for a Hindu-supremacist militia to achieve the “ideal” of “a Hindu as a dictator... like Mussolini or Hitler of the present day Italy and Germany”. In 1935, Moonje explained that his aim was to also militarise Hindu society so as to completely choke off any other expressions of social life – “There will thus be no longer any distinction between the citizen and the soldier, between the civilian and the man in uniform.”

In 1939, Moonje expressed the hope that the RSS “might be useful and handy” in the task of preparing such a Hindu-supremacist militia. Who would it fight? Not so much the British Raj or potential Japanese invaders, but “internal enemies” – i.e., Muslims and the Congress wing of the freedom struggle. Moonje specifically visualised a conflict between “the mutually antagonistic and clashing ideologies”, i.e., between “the Rifle” (symbolising the Hindutva militia) and “the Charka” (symbolising Gandhi). Nearly a decade later, Nathuram Godse wielded the Rifle that killed Gandhi.

The road ahead

Today, a woman who proudly declared herself a ‘fan of Godse’ and said the very name ‘Gandhi’ is like a ‘*gaali*’ (a swear word), has been elevated to the leadership of the Bharatiya Janata Party’s social media cell. As has a man who used foul abuse against Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi, and the “b****y voting right” for Muslims and oppressed castes as the “root cause” of India’s problems. Meanwhile, online and offline pro-Modi mobs as well as police are hounding student protesters, especially girls and women. The pretext is that the students, as a last resort, raised profane slogans at Mr. Modi himself, which turned out to be the only thing to move him to remove his corrupt Minister.

Will these mobs, together with the moral policing mobs and the anti-Muslim lynch mobs, be elevated to the ranks of Mr. Modi’s ‘civilian defence force’? This is a real danger, given that his supporters believe he is the ‘Hindu Hitler’ of Moonje’s and Hedgewar’s dreams.

Uttarakhand and China, the mountains are warning us”, August 28, 2026), explained how China’s construction of Medog, the world’s largest hydropower project, at the great bend of the Brahmaputra river just across the border and very close to the Paizhen Fault, could (should there be a major earthquake in the project’s vicinity), cause a massive discharge of floodwaters and debris into India’s northeast. India’s salutary initiatives to bring about a measure of mature civility on the borders with China must now include frankness about the ferocious danger that Medog poses.

Sixth, an urgent review of India’s own built hazards such as dams and reactors in the high risk zones followed by the dismantling of the real ‘baddies’ can no longer be postponed.

Seventh, and no less difficult but no less important, a calibrated but time-bound decongestion of human agglomerations in high-risk zones.

Eighth, if surgical strikes can be used with precision and without excesses against an external enemy to good effect, their civilian equivalent should be deployed to disable that which, though intended for our well-being, has become a danger.

Progress and danger

Marjorie Sykes was a British devotee of India, in the tradition of C.F. Andrews, Verrier Elwin and J.B.S. Haldane. I once heard her say with passion: “Dams are a damnation.” All dams may not be, but some, depending on their location, are. Likewise, some reactors can become rakshasas. And some commercial behemoths, predatory.

A big and great nation can learn from the experience of a small neighbour. Especially when both are perched on the same living rock that threatens to turn into a mass grave.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Uphold Bar standards

Lawyers have played a significant role in modern India, in shaping our society and polity, particularly during the freedom struggle and after Independence (Front page, “Not a good sign if a Bar Council loses respect: SC judge”, August 30). Many stalwarts have graced the higher judiciary, conducted themselves with the utmost dignity, upheld professional values, and brought respect to the Bar. The Bar Council of India has also largely done well in regulating the legal profession and maintaining

professional standards. However, recent developments have caused dismay within the legal community and beyond. The widely criticised decision directing the State Bar Councils to halt the enrolment of the NALSAR 2026 batch, and its subsequent reversal, have cast the Bar Council of India in a poor light. The call by Supreme Court judge Justice B.V. Nagarathna urging the Bar Councils to “introspect on their role and importance in upholding professional ethics, morality and professional

competence” is timely. The Bar Councils should take note of this.

Kosaraju Chandramouli,
Hyderabad

No country above the law

If Russia’s actions against Ukraine and Iran’s actions against Kuwait are condemned, why should similar conduct by the United States be treated differently? Venezuela is a sovereign nation, not an American colony whose natural resources can be controlled at Washington’s will. The reported U.S. control over

Venezuelan oil raises serious questions about national sovereignty and international law. The United Nations appears to become a “sleeping beauty” whenever a powerful nation acts with impunity. International law must apply equally to every country; no nation should

be above it. Otherwise, global institutions risk encouraging dictators who believe that power makes them untouchable.

T. Kailash Ditya,
Hyderabad

The spirit of Madras
The Hindu and the citizens of Chennai deserve praise

Corrections & Clarifications

In an article, “The long wait for a woman Minister in Karnataka” (Opinion page – ‘State of Play’, August 13, 2026), a sentence read: “Since then, the share has fluctuated, with the 1972 election seeing not even a single woman elected to the Assembly out of the 28 who contested.” It should have said, “Since then, the share has fluctuated from election to election.”

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for making Madras Day a vibrant tribute to the city’s heritage. From soul-stirring music, dance and food festivals to heritage walks, photographic exhibitions and quizzes, this collaborative initiative beautifully brings together history and community while proudly showcasing the timeless charm and rich legacy of Madras to the world.

T.S. Karthik,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Should the CJP be a political party?

A glimpse at India's recent history suggests that while some protest movements became successful political parties, others did not. The success of the recent youth movement started by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) should not be judged by whether it would become a successful political party nor by its forcing the former Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan to resign. Rather, the success of the CJP movement should be judged by the enthusiastic participation of young students for a cause which concerned them; the success of which has raised confidence in them.

They now believe that they can make the government hear their voices even if it is raised from a non-political platform.

Movements to parties

Very often the success of a movement is judged by not only what the movement was able to achieve but whether it was able to become a successful political party or not. The 1979 student's agitation in Assam led by the All Assam Students Union transformed into a successful political party, the Asom Gana Parishad (AGP), which formed the government in 1985 in Assam. The India against corruption movement also transformed into a political party – the Aam Adami Party (AAP) which came to power in Delhi for the first time in 2013. Not only did the India against corruption movement draw large support, the AAP also enjoyed massive electoral gains; it won 67 and 62 seats out of a total of 70 Assembly



Sanjay Kumar

Professor and election analyst. Views expressed are personal

If the CJP does turn into a political party, there is hardly any doubt that it will attract young voters

seats in Delhi with a 54.3% and 53.5% vote share during the 2015 and 2020 Assembly elections respectively.

The AAP also formed a government in Punjab in 2022.

In the success story of both the AGP and AAP, the youth played an important role. During the 2015 Assembly elections, the AAP's vote share among young voters (18-22 years of age) was 63%, almost 10% higher compared to its average vote share. The AAP went on to draw 60% of the votes among young voters (18-22 years) during the 2020 Assembly elections as well – 7% higher compared to its average vote share.

If the CJP does turn into a political party, there is hardly any doubt that the new party will attract young voters, as has been the case with other newly formed parties. The newly formed Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), led by actor-turned politician C. Joseph Vijay, formed the government in Tamil Nadu in the very first election it contested in 2026, replacing the two established formations mainly the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam. The youth played a very important role in the victory of the TVK. While the overall vote share of the TVK was 34.9%, its share among young voters (18-22) was significant at nearly 70%.

Nationally, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has an advantage among young voters, its vote share being 4% higher amongst voters in the age group of 18-22 years. Therefore, the rise of the CJP may affect the BJP more than any other party.

But the question remains, can the CJP attract young

voters across the country?

Strong challengers

There have also been successful social movements which have failed as political parties. The movement for a separate State of Uttarakhand resulted in the formation of a new State and a new political party, the Uttarakhand Kranti Dal (UKD). However, it failed to make an electoral impact. During the 2002 election, which was the first election held after the formation of Uttarakhand, the UKD polled only 5.4% votes and won just four Assembly seats. There have been similar groups which have led protest movements, demanding Statehood and the like, but most of them could not become successful political parties.

However, there have been movements led by the youth, with the participation of larger social communities, which resulted in a change of the national government. The Jayaprakash Narayan led anti-emergency movement of 1977 dethroned the powerful Indira Gandhi-led government. Similarly, the anti-corruption movement led by Anna Hazare contributed to the defeat of the Congress-led coalition government in 2014.

It should be of no concern whether the CJP becomes a political party or not as the movement has already been able to achieve some noticeable milestones. It emphasised that issues take importance and not leaders as this movement was largely leaderless without the active support of any political party.

It also gave a large number of people the hope that their voices can be heard if they come together in a sustained manner.

Adopt policies for reuse of treated water

The recently notified treated wastewater reuse policies for Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand offer an instructive example of what contextualised policymaking can look like. Developed through an extensive consultative process, these policies do not apply a one-size-fits-all template. They account for the stark geographical diversity within each State, the distinct needs of hill communities versus densely populated plains, and embed principles such as fit-for-purpose reuse approaches, integration with urban planning and river rejuvenation, community participation, blended finance and public-private partnership pathways, and digital monitoring systems that make reuse accountable.

However, examples such as these remain the exception rather than the rule. Every summer, Indian States make headlines grappling with water scarcity and yet, the story never seems to change. Rampant groundwater extraction, and the relentless tug-of-war between agriculture, industry, and urban demand have become a recurring script. The real question is no longer whether India needs to rewrite this narrative, but how much longer it can afford not to.

Hidden opportunity

Treated wastewater is an untapped resource waiting to be mainstreamed. For agriculture, industry, urban landscaping, and ecological restoration, it offers something increasingly rare: a reliable, drought-proof supply. India's water future may hinge less on



Sonia Grover

Water policy expert at Mu Gamma consultants



Girija Bharat

Water policy expert at Mu Gamma consultants

discovering new freshwater reserves and more on the intelligence with which the country recycles what it already has. National missions such as the Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation have done commendable work in scaling sewage treatment infrastructure, but pipes and plants alone do not close the loop. A treatment facility that discharges into a drain rather than feeding a farm or a factory is infrastructure without purpose.

What India needs is an ecosystem that converts capacity into practice: institutional coordination across departments, pricing signals that make reuse economically rational, quality standards that inspire confidence in end-users, and city-level roadmaps that translate national ambition into local action. The National Framework on Safe Reuse of Treated Water (SRTW), 2022 offers precisely the canvas India needs to navigate this transition. More than a guiding document, it represents a policy signal that reuse is no longer peripheral – it is a national priority. By mandating States to develop their own reuse policies, the Framework acknowledges that water solutions must ultimately be local, even when the vision is national. Several States have already responded, putting in place policies that set reuse targets and chart a path toward measurable milestones.

Treated wastewater, reframed correctly, is not a waste management problem; it is an economic opportunity. Its case rests on hard, computable value – building climate resilience, drought-proofing cities,

reducing costly dependence on freshwater, enabling industrial and urban growth without straining existing supplies, and supporting low-carbon urban development at scale. Until this economic case is made clearly and credibly to State governments and planners, the policy will remain an aspiration.

Reuse succeeds only when utilities, urban departments, irrigation agencies, and industries stop working in silos and start working in an integrated manner. The financial momentum needed to hit reuse targets is rarely found in new budgetary allocations alone; it is unlocked by identifying synergies with existing schemes and convergence opportunities across programmes that are already funded and moving.

Need for awareness

There is one more constituency that cannot be overlooked: the public. Misconceptions about the safety of treated water run deep. The National SRTW Framework as well as the reuse policies for Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand have chosen to call treated water *Apna Jal* (our water), signalling something that no document can fully capture: that the shift India needs is not just infrastructural but psychological.

Experts working with State governments are witnessing a quiet shift in thinking – that the safe reuse of treated water is not just a policy consideration but a strategic imperative. Yet, several States remain on the sidelines. States that have not yet adopted a clear plan for water security through reuse are not just falling behind, they are running out of time to catch up.

Nepal disaster a grim reminder to rethink preparedness

The flash floods in Nepal have made it imperative for countries to be better prepared for natural disasters that are becoming unpredictable and frequent

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy

The dire human and economic cost of the catastrophic flash floods in Nepal on August 26, serves as a stark reminder to countries of the urgent need to strengthen their disaster resilience and preparedness.

Nepal, which bore the brunt of the latest glacial collapse, was already identified as being increasingly vulnerable to Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs). As per the UN Development Program, the country had experienced 26 GLOF events since the 1970s. Data show that the world has lost over 9,500 gigatonnes of its glacier mass since 1975 (**Chart 1**). Several mountain ranges in the Himalayan region such as Central Himalaya (which includes Nepal and India's Uttarakhand) have recorded over 20% decline in glacier area in three decades (**Chart 2**).

With natural disasters becoming frequent (**Chart 3**), it is imperative for governments to assess and be better prepared for disasters. Just this month, Indonesia witnessed a 7.7 magnitude earthquake, China battled typhoons, and several European countries combated wildfires.

Massive death tolls aside, they displace millions of people (**Chart 4**). Further, the economic cost of damages spans several billions (**Chart 5**). Nepal's Finance Minister told *Reuters* that the country would require about \$4 billion to \$5 billion to rebuild, nearly a tenth of their economy.

Climate change impacts countries disproportionately. An assessment of vulnerability (exposure, sensitivity, and ability to adapt) and readiness (ability to leverage investments to adaptation actions) of countries show that several low- and lower-middle income countries remain highly vulnerable and less ready to deal with such disasters (**Table 1**).

Stark warning

The data for charts were sourced from Our World in Data, EM-DAT, International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development (ICIMOD)'s "Changing Dynamics of Glaciers in the Hindu Kush Himalayan Region 1990–2020", Notre Dame Global Adaptation Initiative scores (2024) and Copernicus Climate Change Service (C3S)

CHART 1: Annual change in glacier mass globally. Figures in gigatonnes

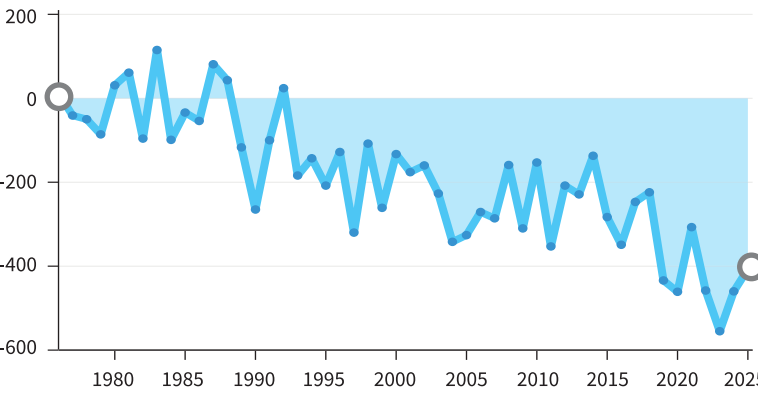


CHART 2: Changes in glacier area between 1990 and 2020 across mountain ranges in the Hindu Kush Himalaya region, as mentioned in ICIMOD's report. Figures in %

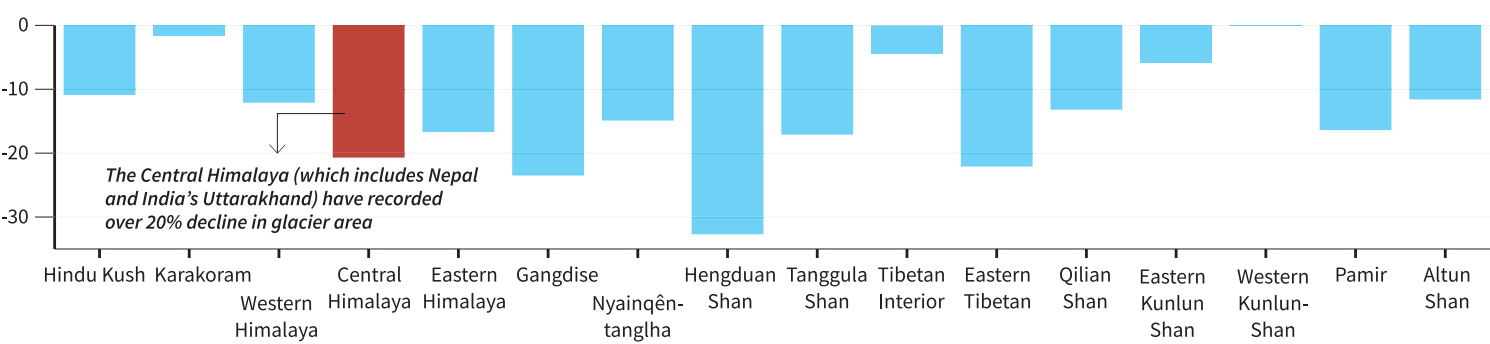


CHART 3: Reported number of natural disasters across the world since 1990

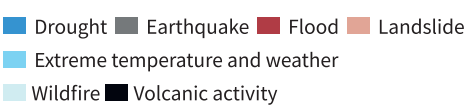


CHART 4: People displaced internally due to natural disasters each year. Figures in million

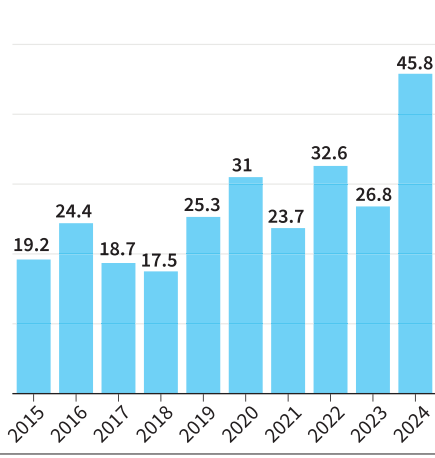
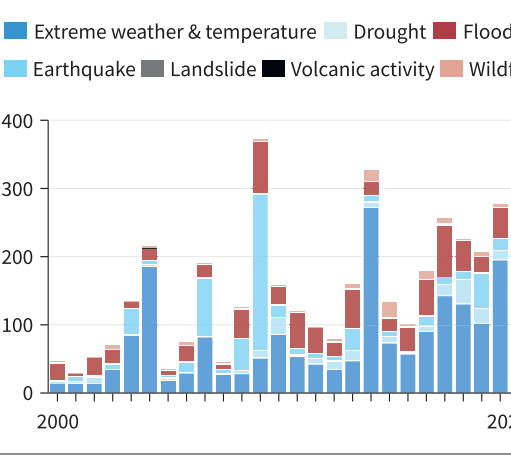


CHART 5: Economic damage caused by natural disasters globally. Figures in \$ billion



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 31, 1976

China supports India for Security Council seat

New Delhi, August 30: The Chinese Ambassador-designate, Mr. Chen Chao Yusu, is expected to arrive in Delhi in the next two weeks and present his credentials well before October 1 to make his first public appearance at the Embassy's national day reception.

As a happy augury to the restoration of Ambassador-level representation, China has fallen in line with the rest of the Asian Group in the United Nations in supporting India's candidature for one of the two Asian seats on the Security Council to be vacated by Japan on completion of its two-year term.

At the Asian Group meeting in New York on August 16, which incidentally was presided over by the Bangladesh representative, China went along with the other members in supporting Japan's suggestion that India should be nominated for this seat. The other two countries in the field, the Philippines and Mongolia, withdrew in India's favour after several countries spoke in support of its candidature.

In accordance with the normal practice, the Bangladesh Chairman of the 34-member Asian Group has formally notified the other regional groups of its decision to nominate India.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 31, 1926

The right of pathway bill

Mr. Saldanha presented the report of the Select Committee on the Bill to amend the Madras District Municipalities Act 1920 and moved that the Bill be taken into consideration at once. He said that the right of public pathway should be given to all classes in respect of roads and streets maintained at the expense of the municipality. The principles of this Bill were the same as the principles of Mr. Veerian's Bill.

Some of the members opposed the motion on the ground that the Bill as amended was not received by them in time and pointed out that material alterations had been made by the Select Committee and asked the President not to suspend the operation of the Standing Order.

The Chief Minister admitted that there had been a change and left the question to be decided by the President. The Hon. Mr. Marjoribanks wished to know if the Bill in its present form had received the previous sanction of the Governor-General.

M CH-CHE

BJP chief’s ideation session focuses on Gen-Z outreach

Some leaders suggest avoiding the term ‘Gen Z’ and instead using the broader term ‘youth’ or references to specific age groups; party decides to galvanise its existing voter base and cadres

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

BJP national president Nitin Nabin’s brainstorming session on Saturday on the party’s engagement with Gen Z included suggestions to abandon the term altogether and simply refer to the cohort as the “youth”, as well as initiating a simultaneous outreach to the party’s older voters.

The meeting in New Delhi, under a youth outreach initiative headed by Mr. Nabin, was attended by around 45 young leaders with party general secretary Smriti Irani and Chhattisgarh Minister O.P. Choudhary as committee members.

According to sources, participants were invited to share their views on how the party could improve dialogue and participation among young people.

Several attendees argued that it would be incorrect to treat all young people as a homogenous, single category, stressing that different groups of youth have distinct aspira-



The meeting under the youth outreach initiative was headed by BJP national president Nitin Nabin in New Delhi. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

tions and concerns.

Sources said some participants suggested avoiding the term “Gen Z” and instead using the broader term “youth” or references to specific age groups.

The “horizontal solidarity” among the age cohort witnessed during the recent Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led protests over the NEET exam paper ‘leak’ was one thing, said an attendee, but that did not mean that all young people shared the same life experiences or even aspirations. “Young people in Tier-two cities and villages will have different ideas about life, their opportuni-

ties and what they think on various issues,” they said, advocating for a graded engagement with different kinds of youngsters.

A number of participants underlined the need for differentiated engagement strategies and communication methods for various categories of young people.

One participant noted that while greater engagement with the youth is essential, the party must take care that older supporters and long-time party backers do not feel neglected or sidelined. Another suggested that energising the party’s veteran workers is just

as important as expanding outreach among youth, and that efforts should also be made to strengthen cadres’ confidence in the leadership.

The 45 participants in the meeting have reportedly been divided into five or six groups. Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi and Chhattisgarh’s O.P. Choudhary are among those tasked with leading the groups. Participants have been asked to send their suggestions to their respective team leaders, who will compile them for further consideration.

All participants have been asked to submit their recommendations within the next seven or eight days.

According to sources, the recommendations gathered from these 45 leaders will be considered for implementation in future party programmes. Preparations are also under way for youth-focused activities during the coming “Seva Sankalp Mahotsav”, which will mark 25 years of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s public service journey.

Bihar Cong. leaders plan Delhi protest for removal of in-charge, State chief

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A group of Bihar Congress leaders has written to party president Mallikarjun Kharge, stating that they will stage a peaceful sit-in outside the party headquarters, Indira Bhavan, in New Delhi on September 8, unless the Bihar unit in-charge Krishna Allavaru and State president Rajesh Kumar are removed.

The proposed protest comes amid discontent within the Bihar Congress following its poor performance in the 2025 Assembly election, in which the party won six seats, down from 19 in 2020.

In a letter dated August 15, the workers alleged “disorder” in the Bihar Pradesh Congress Committee during the Assembly election and accused Mr. Allavaru of acting arbitrarily in the distribution of ticket.

Anand Madhab, former chairperson of the Congress Manifesto Committee for the 2020 Assembly election, said a delegation had met Mr. Kharge and other senior leaders on November 3, 2025, to raise concerns over the functioning of the State unit.



Bihar Congress national in-charge Krishna Allavaru and State president Rajesh Kumar. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

“We discussed how genuine workers were denied tickets and people from other parties got tickets. They promised to pay heed to us, but since then there has been no redress,” Mr. Madhab said.

The delegation submitted a representation to Mr. Kharge during the meeting and was assured that the complaints would be examined and action taken after the election, the letter said.

“More than 10 months have passed, and the Bihar Congress is going from bad to worse. Therefore, we are left with no other option than to protest before the headquarters,” Mr. Madhab said.

Senior Congress leader from Bihar, Kishore Kumar

Jha, supported the concerns raised by the workers, but said their grievances could be addressed through discussions. “They are dedicated Congress workers, and the party high command should listen to their grievances,” Mr. Jha said.

The protesters include former Bihar Congress vice-presidents Jamal Ahmed and Rajkumar Rajan, AICC member Nagen- dra Paswan, former MLA Chhatrapati Yadav, former BPCC secretary B. Akhtar, and former MLA Anil Kumar Singh.

The signatories said their campaign was aimed at saving the party organisation in Bihar and urged the leadership to meet them before September 8.

OBC groups seek unique code for castes in Census

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A national OBC conference on Sunday demanded that the Union government make caste enumeration mandatory in the nationwide Census and assign a separate “unique code” to every caste. Conducting a Census without these measures would be a waste of public money, and the exercise should be halted until a nationwide consensus is reached on the issue, OBC leaders said.

The conference was chaired by former IAS officer and chairman of the Backward Classes Intellectual Forum T. Chiranjeevulu, and All India OBC Students Association president G. Kiran Kumar.

Without assigning a unique code to every caste, the speakers said, the Census could not be scientifically sound. “Just as separate columns are provided for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, separate columns should also be created for OBCs and the General Category,” several speakers said.

The speakers also cautioned the government that a nationwide movement could follow if their demand was ignored.

National law varsity yet to take shape in Uttarakhand

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The recent student protests at some National Law Universities (NLUs) over institutional accountability have put the spotlight on Uttarakhand, where 15 years after its Assembly approved a law to establish an NLU, the State does not have a single functional law university.

The delay stands out when compared with the two other States created in November 2000 – Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. While Chhattisgarh established the Hidayatullah National Law University in Raipur in 2003, Jharkhand set up the National University of Study and Research in Law in Ranchi in 2010.

Former Uttarakhand Chief Minister Harish Rawat said students of the State were suffering because of the delay in setting up an NLU campus. “This issue has been caught in the BJP’s petty internal politics but students are paying a price.”

The Uttarakhand legislature passed the National Law University Act in 2011. Fifteen years later, the proposed institution has neither a permanent campus nor students. Its location has shifted repeatedly: from Bhowali in Nainital district to Pantnagar in Udham Singh Nagar and Ranipokhari near Dehradun and now Haldwani is under consideration.

The uncertainty over Uttarakhand’s NLU site reached the High Court, which in 2018 directed the State government to establish the university. The court also said that academic sessions need not wait for a permanent campus and could begin from a government building or rented premises. In 2019, then Chief Minister Trivendra Singh Rawat laid the foundation stone at Ranipokhari for what was projected as the country’s 23rd NLU. Seven years later, the university remains non-functional.

Justice Bhuyan calls for appointing ‘brilliant minds’ from legal academia as judges in SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

As student bodies across premier national universities object to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant’s remarks and refuse to have him over for their convocations, Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Sunday pushed for the activation of presidential power to directly appoint “distinguished jurists”, including legal academicians, as judges in the top court of the country.

“While our Constitution has a provision for appointment of a jurist as a judge of the Supreme Court, no jurist has been appointed so far to the Supreme Court though the Constitution has completed more than 76 years,” Justice Bhuyan pointed out at the 13th convocation of the National Law University, Delhi.

Justice Bhuyan said that as important as the right to question was the tolerance to disagreement. “A democratic society cannot be built on the edifice that



Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan says a ‘distinguished jurist’ could be a great value addition to the Bench. PTI

everyone will think alike,” he said.

Bar Council row

The comments from the Supreme Court judge follow a recent debacle by the Bar Council of India, which ordered State Bar Councils to bar the professional enrolment of the 2026 batch of NALSAR students for objecting to have CJI Kant over as the chief guest for their convocation over his oral comments in court using terms such as “cockroach” and “parasites”. The BCI had to retract the order after public pres-

sure. “Tolerance is not merely a matter of personal courtesy. It is a constitutional value. A democracy becomes meaningful not when everyone speaks the same language of thought, but when different voices can co-exist, be heard and be treated with dignity,” Justice Bhuyan said.

The judge said the maturity of a democracy was reflected not merely in how it responded to opinions that were difficult, unpopular or inconvenient. The courage to voice unpopular opinions began

at universities, the Supreme Court judge said.

He said the 76-year reluctance to activate Article 124(3) for appointment of legal academics as Supreme Court judges in the category of “distinguished jurists” may have been either due to the feeling that there was not enough “depth in the Indian academia” or because the provision was simply not seriously taken. As a result, brilliant minds, men and women with legal scholarship, who could have significantly contributed on the Bench missed the opportunity to serve as judges of the Supreme Court.

Justice Bhuyan dismissed the oft-repeated argument that legal academics and scholars lack the practical experience that serve judges. “But this is a very shallow objection. Supreme Court is not only the highest adjudicatory body but it is the moral, legal and constitutional conscience keeper of the nation. It is above technicalities. The reason for having this provision of

distinguished jurist in Article 124(3) is to diversify the Bench with talented judges,” he said.

Who is a jurist?

In India, the judge said, the term “jurist” was being applied very loosely.

“A lawyer or a judge of repute is often described as a jurist. Certainly, a lawyer and a judge can be a jurist, and there are many such instances, but in the context of Article 124(3), it extends beyond the above two categories. A person who is skilled in law or knowledgeable in the field of law would be qualified to be termed as a ‘jurist,’” Justice Bhuyan said.

A ‘distinguished jurist’ could be a great value addition to the Bench. By his or her scholarship, he or she can make a visible contribution to the decision-making process at the top level. Participation of renowned legal academia and scholars would have a defining impact on the judicial functioning of the Supreme Court, Justice Bhuyan said.

Tejashwi asks Chirag, Manjhi to fight from unreserved seats

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Amid the verbal clash between Bihar’s two Union Ministers, Chirag Paswan and Jitan Ram Manjhi, over reservation and demands for each other’s resignation, Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) leader Tejashwi Yadav on Sunday drew both of them to contest elections from unreserved seats. Earlier, Mr. Manjhi and his son Santosh Kumar Suman had sought a review of the reservation policy and sub-categorisation of Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.

Reacting to their state-

ment, Mr. Paswan said that if they talked about the creamy layer, then both father and son should resign as they too fall under the creamy layer. Mr. Yadav alleged that both Union Ministers were acting on Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh’s (RSS) instructions. He said both were speaking in contradictory terms to divert attention from the BJP-RSS’s agenda of abolishing reservation.

“If they hold such intense hatred for reservation, they should start contesting elections from unreserved seats; that would open their eyes,” Mr. Yadav said.



BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Through KPP Portal Only) - 2nd Call

BWSSB invites tenders in two stage tender system from eligible contractors for the following works.

Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount put to Tender
		EMD Amount
Office of The Engineer-In-Chief, 2nd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bangalore - 560 009.		
IFT No.:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS & DCW)/TA/2821/2026-27		Date:29.08 .2026
1	Providing, Supply and laying of 700mm and 400mm dia MS pipeline in place of leaky 700mm and 40mm dia CI feeder line from Cantonment Railway Station to Bharath Petrol Bunk in Cantonment Road under AEE(UFW) Sub Division.	Rs. 358.74 Lakhs Rs.5.38 Lakhs
IFT No.:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS & DCW)/TA/2823/2026-27		Date:29.08 .2026
2	Providing, Supply and laying of 700mm and 400mm dia MS pipeline in place of leaky 700mm and 40mm dia CI feeder line from Bharath Petrol Bunk to in Cantonment Road to AKS Conventional Hall under AEE(UFW) Sub Division.	Rs. 366.33 Lakhs Rs. 6.49Lakhs

For the above works, Last date for receipt of tenders: **14.09.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.** The bids will be opened on: **15.09.2026 at 16.30 Hrs.**

Sd/- Engineer-In-Chief

The details regarding the tender and participatin in the e-procurement process can be obtained by logging on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.

DIPR/CP/JA/2484/2026-27

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Speculation abounds about a possible Special Session of Parliament to revive the Delimitation Bill, with the Monsoon Session yet to be prorogued, or formally ended, 17 days after the last meeting of the House.

On August 13, both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha were adjourned *sine die*, bringing Parliament’s Monsoon Session to a close.

However, the Session is yet to end formally. It remains technically alive, allowing the government to reconvene Parliament without issuing a fresh presidential summons.

The Congress has continued to press for clarity, questioning the unusual delay. “The continued delay in prorogation is mystifying and certainly leads to suspicions that some mischief is afoot. The Home Minister does not have a super-tainted two-thirds majority and is probably engaging in mind games of bluff and bluster,” Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh told *The Hindu*.

Party president Mallikarjun Kharge, in a letter to Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday, reiterated the party’s position on delimitation, insisting that the existing strength of Lok Sabha be frozen at 543 seats for next 15 years.



AMARAVATI GROWTH AND INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGILCL)

2nd Floor, APCRDA Office, Rayavadi, Thulluru Mandal, (A.P)

E-Procurement Tender Notice

RFP No. 19/MD/CE/AGILCL/2026 Date:29.08.2026

Name of Work: "RFP for Consultancy Services for Re-validation and updation of the Detailed Project Report (DPR), 2019 for the Inner Ring Road (IRR), Amaravati." The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **31-August-2026 15:00 hrs.** For further details, please refer to www.approcurement.gov.in and www.agilcl.org

Sd/- Managing Director, AGILCL, Amaravati



Telangana Trade Promotion Corporation Ltd.

(Formerly TSIPC Ltd.) (An Undertaking of Government of Telangana)

Regd. Office: 6-16-174, Shakti Bhavan, 2nd Floor, Fath Maidan Road, Hyderabad -500 004, Telangana, India. Tel: +91 040-23237591

Email: info@tgtpc.org, <https://tgtpc.telangana.gov.in> CIN: U74991TG2014SGC095847

TIN: TGTPC/DoI/HIPC/Industrial Policy 2.0/2026 Date:31.08.2026

Tender Notice Inviting Request for Proposals

(Through e-procurement portal of Government of Telangana)

Commissioner of Industries invites Request For Proposals/Bids through e-procurement portal of the Government of Telangana from reputed Consultancy organizations for - **Selection of a Consultant services for support in industrial promotion and support to the State Government in the Formulation of Industrial Policy 2.0, Aerospace & Defense Policy, Global Capability Centre (GCC) Policy, Data Centre Policy, Footwear & Lifestyle Policy, Textile and Apparel Policy 2.0, Information and Communication Technology (ICT) Policy 2.0, Electronics Policy 2.0 for the state of Telangana - Publication of Notice Inviting (RFQ cum RFP).**

(1) (a) Earnest Money Deposit: Rs. 1.00 Lakhs (Rs. One Lakh) by way of online

(b) Tendering & Processing Fee: Rs. 11,800/- (Rs. Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred Only) by way of online in favor of TSIPC Ltd, Hyderabad.

(2) RFP can be viewed and downloaded from Website: <https://tender.telangana.gov.in> NIT: TGTPC/DoI/HIPC/Industrial Policy 2.0/2026, Tender ID: 729418 on 31.08.2026 from 2:00 PM onwards.

(3) Last date & time for submission of proposals online: 24.09.2026 by 5 PM.

(4) Col reserves the right to cancel this notification without assigning any reason whatsoever.

(5) For further information contact Jt. Director (IIPC) of DoI, Mob. 9640092967.

DIPR R.O.No.: 479-PPLCL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:31.05.2025 Sd/-MANAGING DIRECTOR



Government of Tamil Nadu

ELECTRONICS CORPORATION OF TAMIL NADU LIMITED - ANGADI

9th Floor, Sigai Aachi Building, 18/3, Rukmani Lakshmiipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008 | GST No.33AAACE1670K42R +91 44 2855 1234 | elcotangadi.in.gov.in | tenders@elcotangadi.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender No. E-ANGADI-RC-IT02-2026-0020

ELCOT Angadi invites electronic bids for “**Empanelment of Software OEMs / Authorized Partners for Supply of Software Products, Licenses and Subscriptions through the ELCOT Angadi e-Commerce Portal**” for complete details, please visit www.tntenders.gov.in. Pre-bid meeting: **09.09.2026, 11.00 AM** at ELCOT Nandanam Office. Last date for submission of e-bids: **01.10.2026, 3.00 PM**. For queries: tenders@elcotangadi.in.

DIPR/2702/Tender/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER (PROCUREMENT)**

INBRIEF



FPIs turn buyers for second month, invest ₹30,919 crore

Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) infused ₹30,919 crore in Indian equities in August, extending their buying streak to a second straight month, amid improving corporate earnings, resilient economic activity, stable rupee and easing geopolitical concerns. The inflow follows ₹20,200 crore invested in July, marking a sharp turnaround after four consecutive months of heavy selling. FPIs had withdrawn ₹49,340 crore in June, ₹32,963 crore in May, ₹60,847 crore in April, and a massive ₹1.17 lakh crore in March. Prior to the selling streak, they had invested ₹22,615 crore in February, according to Central Depository Services (India) Ltd. (CDSL) data. PTI

Four die after consuming spurious liquor in Patna

At least four people died allegedly after consuming spurious liquor in dry Bihar's Patna district on Sunday, a police officer said. The incident took place in Bedhna village under the jurisdiction of the Barh police station. According to the families of the deceased, the four men consumed liquor in a room, and they fell ill soon after. They were taken to the nearest government hospital, where they died during treatment. Barh Sub-Divisional Police Officer (SDPO) Ayush Srivastava said the bodies of the victims had been sent for post-mortem examination to ascertain the exact cause of death. The Bihar government imposed a total ban on the sale and consumption of alcohol in the State on April 5, 2016. PTI

Modi stresses need to keep India's youth free from drugs

Students, theatre groups must raise awareness against drug menace, says PM in his *Mann ki Baat* address; 35 lakh women across the country have benefited from PM SVANidhi Yojana, he adds

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has flagged the dangers of drug addiction, highlighted the economic avenues opening up for women and girls in India, including in the space industry, and lauded the cleanliness initiatives being undertaken by citizens. “Drug addiction does not just engulf a single individual. The entire family and society have to bear the consequences,” Mr. Modi said in his 137th *Mann ki Baat* episode on Sunday. “I would like to commend those who raise awareness against drugs and step forward to help individuals struggling with addiction.”

Mr. Modi urged young musicians to produce songs that convey the message of a drug-free life, students and theatre groups to write short plays that highlight the dangers of drugs while also showing the path to recovery, and content creators to spread the message on social media in various languages. “Let us all play our part in this noble mission to

Drug addiction does not just engulf a single individual. The entire family and society have to bear the consequences

NARENDRA MODI
Prime Minister



keep India's youth away from drugs and free from addiction,” Mr. Modi said.

Women empowerment “From morning till evening, lakhs of women across the streets of our cities and towns are engaged in their work,” the Prime Minister noted. “Some sell vegetables or fruits, others run tea stalls, while some sell flowers, earthen lamps, and worship materials.” He added that, often, a lack of capital prevents such businesses from growing further. “But now, lakhs of such mothers and sisters are gaining new strength through the PM SVANidhi Yojana,” Mr. Modi said. “This aspect of wo-

men empowerment is not discussed as much as it should be. Women account for approximately 46% of the beneficiaries of the PM SVANidhi Yojana.”

Through this initiative, 12,000 girl students from 108 countries are getting the opportunity to learn satellite technology and to advance in the field of innovation, he said.

On August 23, celebrated as National Space Day, the second phase of Mission ShaktiSAT was launched at Gautam Buddha University in Greater Noida where around 100 female students from across the country, including remote regions, and various other countries came together.

“The goal of this entire initiative is truly special: preparations are under way to send a satellite – developed entirely through the participation of female students – into lunar orbit,” Mr. Modi said. “I am confident that many of these students will carve out a distinct identity for themselves in the fields of science, technology, and innovation in the future.”

Power failure hits two NEET-PG exam centres in Jaipur

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

The National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) on Sunday constituted a three-member committee to investigate the internal power supply failure that disrupted the NEET-PG 2026 examination at two iON Digital Zone iDZ Sitapura centres in Jaipur, Rajasthan, sources in the NBEMS said.

The NBEMS conducted the NEET-PG examination on Sunday.

The examination was scheduled for 2,73,096 candidates at 1,111 examination centres across 339 cities, covering all 36 States and Union Territories. A total of 2,65,980 candidates appeared for the examination and 2,527 faculty members were appointed as Independent Appraisers to oversee the conduct of the examination. In addition, more than 700 senior faculty members, including Deans, Directors, Medical Superintendents and senior professors, were deployed in flying squads.

“However, a technical disruption occurred at iON Digital Zone iDZ Sitapura Centres, Jaipur, Rajasthan (TC Nos. 41682 and 41683),



A total of 2,65,980 candidates appeared for the examination conducted on Sunday. ANI

where the examination could not be completed for 2,445 candidates due to internal power supply issues at the test centres, attributable to TCS Ltd., the examination conducting agency,” the Union Health Ministry said.

The re-examination for the affected candidates will be conducted at 3 p.m. on September 5 in Jaipur.

The committee has been constituted to examine the circumstances leading to the power supply failure and ascertain the reasons for the disruption.

It includes a senior official from the Government of Rajasthan, a Joint Secretary-level officer from the Ministry, and a senior engineering official from the Central Electricity Authority.

Govt. notifies IST as common time reference across India; gives 180 days for compliance

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Union government has notified the Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026, mandating Indian Standard Time (IST) as the single reference for legal, administrative, commercial and other official purposes across the country.

The nodal Consumer Affairs Ministry notified the rules on August 27. Still, they will come into force 180 days after their publication in the Official Gazette, giving government departments, businesses, and institutions time to align their systems.

The move comes amid growing reliance on digital and technology-based systems—from banking and payments to telecommuni-



The Centre is building facilities to disseminate accurate IST. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

cations, railways, power grids and computer networks—that depend on accurate and synchronised time stamps. The Ministry said inconsistencies between different time sources could affect the coordination and recording of such activities, prompting the push for a uniform national time standard.

The common time reference is expected to sup-

port accurate time-stamping of banking and digital payment transactions, coordination among railways, airports and other transport systems, reliable functioning of telecommunication and internet networks, precise time-keeping in power systems, upkeep of government and legal records, and coordination of emergency and other time-critical services, the Ministry said in a statement.

A key feature of the rules is the emphasis on reducing dependence on foreign satellite-based time sources, which several critical systems currently rely on. The government is building infrastructure to disseminate accurate IST through Indian institutions and legal metrology laboratories.

Study sheds light on early warning signs before eruption of solar flares

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

In a new study, scientists have found small, short-lived brightening in the sun's atmosphere that appear hours before a major solar flare erupts, clustering around the spot where the flare later occurs.

The study was carried out by researchers from the Manipal Centre for Natural Sciences and Manipal Academy of Higher Education, along with scientists from the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), Department of Space, and other academicians.

It used simultaneous ultraviolet (UV) and X-ray observations from three payloads onboard the Aditya-L1 mission.

The Solar Ultraviolet Imaging Telescope (SUIT) payload observed the sun in 11 near-ultraviolet (NUV)



Scientists found numerous small, short-lived brightening 'transient events', occurring before the onset of major flares. GETTY IMAGES

filters, revealing different layers from the upper photosphere to chromosphere, according to the ISRO.

“NUV wavelengths are largely inaccessible from the ground because Earth's atmosphere absorbs most ultraviolet radiation. Complementing SUIT are two X-ray instruments, the Solar Low Energy X-ray Spectrometer (SoLEXS) and the High Energy L1 Orbiting X-ray Spectrometer (HELIOS), which measure

the X-ray emission produced by energetic processes in the solar corona. Combining these data, scientists study how activity in the lower solar atmosphere is linked to energy release in the corona during the build-up to a flare,” the ISRO stated.

Analysing solar flare events, the team found numerous small, short-lived brightening ‘transient events’, occurring in active regions before the onset of

major flares. “Some of these also showed corresponding X-ray signatures, indicating that they involve the release of magnetic energy... These pre-flare transient events clustered around the location where the major flare later occurred. The results suggest that repeated small-scale energy release may progressively destabilise the magnetic field in an active region, eventually leading to a large solar flare,” the ISRO said.

The findings provide valuable insights into the physical processes that trigger solar flares and move scientists a step closer towards reliable flare forecasting, which will ultimately contribute to better space weather prediction; help protect satellites, astronauts, and communication systems; and other critical technologies.

Black flags waved at Maharashtra Deputy CM

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Maratha protesters waved black flags at Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde during the Shiv Sena's farmer-youth interaction programme in Parbhani on Sunday.

The protest comes amid the ongoing indefinite hunger strike by Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange Patil, who is demanding Kunbi caste certificates for the Maratha community. Parbhani is part of the Marathwada division and is located 155 km from Antarwadi Sarati in Jalna district, the site of the protest.

During the event, Mr. Shinde said, “We [Mahayuti government] formed the Shinde committee to give reservation, we also gave 10% reservation to the Maratha community.”

THE HINDU CROSSWORD+ 14886

(set by Hypatia)

12 Doctor separating wounded and serious (6)

14 Protect Sinner — He's lost (8)

15 A scene from Tom & Jerry, possibly in a temporary rally? (4,3,6)

18 Shot group of journalists per Spooner (8)

20 Local icon's clothing fabric (6)

21 Setter in main marketplace (4,6)

22 Field manager regularly clearing sink (4)

23 Keep checking elephants on vacation in jungle (6)

24 Win back in random plan (8)

Down

1 Decline screening said overs set up in camera (8)

2 Eat bananas closer to thick tree (4)

3 Tipsy chemist bottling spirit (6)

4 European crowd introduced to very strong coffee (8)

5 Rich saloon exercises happening at identical intervals (10)

6 Pity engineer spoiling Onam (6)

8 Vanity firm is sentenced wrongly (13)

13 Initially bride needs husband: revolting to go becomes a disgrace to family (5,5)

16 Virtue of unwinding by a trip to spa which is taken frequently (8)

17 Trade banter (8)

19 Yes, this author made say, movies (6)

20 Provides automobiles without deflated tyre (6)

22 Originally France exported tuna and cheese (4)

SUDOKU

2				8			4	9
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				3		9		
	7	5		6	2			
3	8			2				5

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

FAITH

Hari hurries to devotees

Whenever a devotee is in distress, Perumal rushes to his aid as soon as the distress call is made. No matter the magnitude of the problem, if one chants Hari nama, Perumal will appear at one's side. Perumal's abundant love is not restricted to great devotees alone, but also to past sinners who have corrected their ways and surrendered to Him. He grants them moksha, said Tirukkudanthai Dr. Venkatesh.

In Krita yuga, three asuras - Thanjakan, Dandakan and Gajamukhan - had undertaken severe penance, praying to Siva, seeking the boon of everlasting life. When Siva said all humans have to perish in their physical form, they prayed and were granted their wish that death should never come to them in the hands of Siva. The three became egoistic and troubled the entire universe. They interrupted the severe penance being undertaken by sage Parasara, father of Vyasa. Rather than curse them, Parasara cried, 'Hari' three times. Hearing His devotee's cry, Perumal first dispatched Garuda, asking him to vanquish the three, following close behind. The flap of Garuda's wings sent up such fear among the army of the asuras that they all scattered. Perumal arrived like a dark cloud (*Neelamegam*) and aiming at Thanjakan, released the Chakra. The minute the sacred discus touched him, the asura, realising his mistakes and aware that death was upon him, surrendered to Perumal with folded hands. Perumal granted him mukti. Thanjakan sought a boon from Perumal, asking for the town to be named after him. Thanjakan further prayed that He remain in the site, enabling devotees to surrender to Him, Neelamega Perumal, and attain mukti.

Which Nifty is right for you?

Vaishali R. Venkat

Imagine you decide to invest in equity via an index fund. But which market are you actually buying? The 50 biggest firms? The next 50 waiting in the wings? Or, a much broader basket of 500 firms? All three are called Nifty indices, but they can give your money very different rides. So, it's worth asking a simple question: Which one to choose?

It matters because choosing an index fund is not simply a question of picking the one with more number of firms or the one with 'bluechips'. Instead, you are choosing between how much of the market to own and where that exposure comes from.

Nifty 50
The Nifty 50 may give you exposure to 50 large firms but as of July 31, 2026 financial services alone accounted for 36.18%, healthcare 4.82% and power just 2.63% of the index. So, the real question for an investor is: Do you want the largest firms, the next tier of firms, a broader slice of market or a sector mix you are comfortable with?

What if you don't want to bet on which part of the market will win? The Nifty 50 gives you exposure to 50 of the market's largest firms. So, for an investor who wants to keep equity investing simple, it can be a 'perfectly reasonable' one-index approach. But there is an important question hiding beneath: are you comfortable owning mainly the firms that have already turned the market's biggest or also firms that could become tomorrow's 'giants'? That is where the Nifty Next 50 enters the picture.

Nifty Next 50
If the Nifty 50 represents the established 'giants', the Nifty Next 50 takes you one step down the ladder, bringing in the next 50 companies outside the Nifty 50. That makes it an interesting middle ground: you are still investing in relatively large companies but moving beyond the market's biggest names. For an investor who feels the Nifty 50 is too concentrated in today's 'giants' but who does not want to straddle across the entire market, the Next 50 offers a different proposition. The next query is whether you want exposure to the next set of companies in the market-cap hierarchy or prefer the wider spread offered by the Nifty 500.

Nifty 500
What if you don't want to pick a winner? This is where the Nifty 500 changes the scenario altogether. Instead of deciding whether the market's biggest companies or the next tier will do better, you are spreading your exposure much further across the Indian equity market. That can appeal to an investor who does not want to make a call on which segment of the market will lead over the next 10 or 20 years.

The trade-off is equally important: you are also accepting exposure to companies beyond the large-cap universe, which can make the ride different from a Nifty 50 fund. In simple terms, Nifty 50 asks you to back the 'giants'; Nifty Next 50 gives you the 'climbers'; Nifty 500 lets you own a much larger part of the race.

Which one to choose?
There is no single universally "best" index. However, history offers a useful reality check: diversification does not automatically mean lower risk. In NSE Indices' February 2026 Riskometer assessment, all three indices were classified as "Very High" risk, but the scores rose from 5.33 for Nifty 50 to 5.43 for Nifty Next 50 and 5.60 for Nifty 500.

So, while Nifty 500 gives you a much wider slice of the market, it has not been the least risky of the three by this measure. The choice, therefore, is less about finding a "safe" index and more about deciding how much market breadth and volatility you are prepared to accept.

(The writer is an NISM & CRISIL-certified Wealth Manager and certified in NISM's Research Analyst module)



ILLUSTRATION: SAAI

Why gold should form 10% of investment portfolio

Most investors think of portfolio in terms of equity and fixed income but buying gold is not a speculative add-on, it is a structural building block of a well-constructed portfolio

SHINES ABOVE REST

Joydeep Sen

Most investors think of portfolio in terms of equity and fixed income. Gold is an afterthought. That approach misses the point. Gold deserves a deliberate, planned allocation of about 10% of every portfolio and here is why.

A diversifier, not a bet
Long-term data shows gold behaves differently from equity and fixed income in most situations. When equity markets are under stress, gold tends to hold up or even gain. When bond yields rise sharply on inflation worries, gold does well since it is seen as a hedge against currency depreciation. This is the essence of diversification - you don't want all assets moving in the same direction at the same time.

If you run a portfolio with equity and fixed income and allocate 10% to gold, the math works out in your favour as the overall portfolio volatility drops as gold price movements are not synchronised with the other two asset classes. Risk-adjusted or volatility-adjusted return improves. This is how portfolio construction works when you combine assets that do not move in lockstep. You are adding gold as it smoothens the ride.

Global central banks have been briskly adding

Global central banks have been briskly adding gold to reserves with the driving force being the geopolitical environment

gold to reserves.

Central bank buying
Sanctions, trade tensions and a more fragmented world order have made many central banks wary of holding all reserves in U.S. Treasuries. Gold held within a country's own vaults does not carry counterparty risk the way a government bond does. This shift by central banks has been one of the steadiest sources of demand for gold over the past four years.

No trend breaking
Gold has corrected meaningfully from a peak earlier this year. Prices had run up too far too quickly, and some of that froth had to come off. What matters more is if the long-term uptrend is intact. Chartists tracking gold have a technical support line and even after this correction, that line has not been broken. A correction within an intact uptrend is very different from a trend reversal.

Rupee depreciation
Gold price is quoted in U.S. dollars and set daily by the London Bullion Market Association. The price in India is that global dollar

Gold has a inverse relationship with the U.S. dollar (USD). When the USD strengthens, gold in dollar terms tends to soften and vice versa.

price converted into rupees. Over the long run, the rupee had depreciated against the dollar and is likely to continue so. Every time the rupee weakens, it adds to rupee-denominated return from gold over and above whatever the dollar price of gold itself does. This is a tailwind that many investors overlook.

U.S. Fed rate and gold
Gold has an inverse relationship with the U.S. dollar (USD). When the USD strengthens, gold in dollar terms tends to soften and vice versa. The U.S. Federal Reserve is likely to raise interest rates which will act as a headwind for gold.

However, there is a limit to how much the Fed can hike as the U.S. is sitting on a huge pile of debt and higher rates mean higher cost of servicing it. At some point, the arithmetic of debt servicing and growth of economy forces a pause/reversal, in the rate cycle. Investors should see dollar-gold relationship as cyclical on gold's prospects.

Several routes
There are several routes to gold. Sovereign Gold Bonds, offering 2.5% an-

nual interest on top of gold's price appreciation are no longer issued afresh but existing bonds can be bought and sold in the secondary market. Gold Exchange Traded Funds are an evergreen option - you need a demat and trading account with a broker and can buy/sell units. If you do not have a demat account, Gold Funds from mutual funds (MFs) serve the same purpose and you can invest via regular MF folio, including SIP.

More recently, a new avenue has opened up: Electronic Gold Receipts or EGRs. These are SEBI-regulated securities representing direct ownership of physical gold held in accredited vaults. You buy/sell EGRs on the stock exchange, just like a share and they sit in demat account. Each EGR is a receipt against a specific quantity of physical gold with the option to convert holdings into gold bars/coins via withdrawal request subject to charges/taxes. EGRs are available in small denominations making them accessible even to small investors. For those who want transparency of exchange-based pricing along with the comfort of an actual claim on physical gold, EGRs are worth considering as part of the 10% allocation. Whichever route, the underlying point is: gold is not a speculative add-on, it is a structural building block of a well-constructed portfolio.

(Joydeep Sen is a corporate trainer (financial markets) and author)

When age matters

THINKINVESTOR

Are you interested in earning a dividend income? Should source of returns matter? The answer is your age determines preference for source of returns, especially via equity investments

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

In recent times, several stocks have traded at prices that offer good dividend yield. This leads to the question: Are individuals interested in earning a dividend income? Should source of returns matter? Here, we discuss how your age determines your preference for source of returns, especially from equity investments.

Income vs. capital appreciation
Equity investments, like bonds and real estate, offer two sources of returns - income returns and capital appreciation. Income returns arise from dividends received from the firm whose stocks you directly hold. You can also earn dividend income indirectly via net asset value if you invest in mutual funds. Note, this dividend income is reinvested and realised as capital appreciation if you invest in the growth option of a fund.

The choice of returns depends on age. If you are a working executive, your main objective is to accumulate wealth to achieve life goals such as funding child's education and buying a house.

This tilts your preference towards capital appreciation and is tax efficient; you pay taxes only when you sell a stock in direct investments or when you redeem mutual fund units. Now, goal-based investments are typically held for more than 12 months. So, if you have earmarked these investments for a life goal, the gains are likely to be taxed at 12.5% above ₹1.25 lakh in a year. This is because these equity investments will be taxed as long-term capital asset.

What if you are retired? Your active income would have stopped and you now depend on passive income to meet post-retirement expenses.

This means you need monthly income to support lifestyle expenses. Also, most mass-affluent retirees are conservative investors viz. they prefer to conserve capital and consume income. In such cases, they prefer to invest in monthly income bank deposits. Investing in dividend yield stocks may be preferred by some as an additional source of income.

Conclusion
If taxes were the only consideration, then earning dividend income may not be an economical source of returns.

This is because dividend income is taxed at your marginal tax rate. Yet, retirees may prefer dividend as a supplement to their interest income to meet their post-retirement expenses.

In such cases, think of taxes as the cost retirees are willing to incur to consume income without drawing down their investment capital - selling shares or mutual fund units to generate cash flows.

(The author offers training programs for individuals to manage their personal investments)

Personal Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	Loan amount 1 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	Interest Rate (%)	EMI (Rs)	EMI (Rs)	Processing fee
Axis Bank	8.90 onwards	10,355 onwards	2,071 onwards	Up to 2%
Bajaj Finserv	10.00-30.50	10,624-16,177	2,125-3,235	Up to 4.13%
Bank of Baroda*	10.15-18.00	10,660-12,697	2,132-2,539	Up to 2% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Bank of India	10.85-16.15	10,834-12,199	2,167-2,440	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 250; Max. Rs 15,000)
Bank of Maharashtra	9.75-15.00	10,562-11,895	2,112-2,379	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Canara Bank	9.70-15.15	10,550-11,934	2,110-2,387	0.25% (Rs. 500 - Rs. 2,500)
Central Bank of India	11.25 onwards	10,934 onwards	2,187 onwards	Up to 1%
Federal Bank	11.75 - 18.99	11,059 - 12,968	2,212 - 2,594	Up to 3%
HDFC Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to Rs 6,500
HSBC Bank	9.70 onwards	10,562 onwards	2,112 onwards	Up to 1%
ICICI Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 2%
IDFC FIRST Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 3.5%
Indian Overseas Bank	10.25 onwards	10,685 onwards	2,137 onwards	Up to 0.75%
IndusInd Bank	10.49 onwards	10,744 onwards	2,149 onwards	Up to 3.5% (2% for instant personal loans for limited period)
Kotak Mahindra Bank	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Up to 5%
Poonawalla Fincorp	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 4%
Punjab & Sind Bank	9.65-13.90	10,538-11,608	2,108-2,322	0.50%-1%
Punjab National Bank	10.25-16.80	10,685-12,373	2,137-2,475	Up to 1%
State Bank of India	10.00-15.00	10,624-11,895	2,125-2,379	Up to 1.50% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Tata Capital	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Flat Rs. 49
UCO Bank	9.95 - 13.20	10,611-11,428	2,122-2,286	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 750)
Union Bank of India	8.90 - 12.65	10,355-11,287	2,071-2,257	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 7,500)

*Interest concession of 0.10% to customers opting for group credit life insurance.

Car Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	Interest Rate (%)	EMI (Rs)	Processing fee
Bank of Baroda	7.60 - 11.35	10,043 - 10,959	Up to Rs. 2,000
Bank of India	7.60-12.55	10,043 - 11,262	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 10,000)
Bank of Maharashtra*	7.45-11.75	10,007 - 11,059	NIL (Limited Period Monsoon Offer)
Canara Bank**	7.45-11.45	10,007 - 10,984	0.25% (Rs 1,000 - Rs 5,000)
Central Bank of India	7.50-9.30	10,019 - 10,452	NIL (Till 31.12.2026)
HDFC Bank	8.15 onwards	10,174 onwards	Up to 0.5% (Rs. 3,500 - Rs. 8,000)
ICICI Bank	8.40 onwards	10,234 onwards	Up to Rs. 8,500
IDFC FIRST Bank	8.99 onwards	10,377 onwards	Up to Rs. 10,000
Indian Bank	7.50-9.65	10,019 - 10,513	Rs. 1,200
Indian Overseas Bank	7.55-12.00	10,031 - 11,122	NIL
Karnataka Bank	8.13-11.63	10,169 - 11,029	Up to 0.60% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 11,000)
Punjab and Sind Bank***	7.55-14.05	10,031 - 11,647	0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Punjab National Bank	7.60-10.70	10,043 - 10,797	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 1,500)
State Bank of India	8.70 - 9.85	10,307 - 10,587	Rs. 500 - Rs. 2,000
UCO Bank	7.35-10.00	9,983 - 10,624	0.5% (Max. Rs 5,000)
Union Bank of India	7.50-10.00	10,019 - 10,684	Up to Rs 1,000

*0.25% interest rate concession for existing home loan borrowers and other existing customers having at least 6 months of relationship with the bank.

**50% waiver on processing fee till September 30

***Concession of up to 50% on processing fee for PSB Apna Vahan Sugam.

Rates and charges as on August 26

Source: Paisabazaar.com

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.

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AFF

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CM
Y
K

Noted commentator Mary Carillo inducted into the Hall of Fame



Emotional Federer breaks down during Hall of Fame speech



It's amazing to see yourself in a place like this, says Federer



‘Not just playing, not just winning,
but creating something new’



Fame was never the goal, but this is one of the greatest honours: Federer

Pegula wins the battle of nerves in her opener

Shafali on song before bowlers choke Thailand

United has lift-off via Fernandes hat-trick

Clean strike: Fernandes caps off a break-away for United's opener.
REUTERS

Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Hub of Growth and Investment



Policy
Reforms



Financial
Incentives



Institutional
Support

Under the visionary leadership of PM Narendra Modi and the impeccable governance of CM Pushkar Singh Dhami, policy reforms, financial incentives, and institutional support have made Uttarakhand a robust ecosystem for MSMEs and startups



ALL PICS: DPIR, UTTARAKHAND GOVT



I congratulate the Uttarakhand government on the remarkable progress achieved in the last few years through sustained policy push and focus on key sectors such as tourism and renewable energy. The state has made significant strides in infrastructure, setting new benchmarks for sustainable growth. U'khand's commitment to harnessing its natural resources and promoting tourism will bolster its economy and showcase its potential on the global stage.

Narendra Modi,
Prime Minister

The investment-related agreements made with the industry groups during the investor conference are now rapidly coming to the ground. This is also creating new employment opportunities in Uttarakhand. We are providing all possible assistance to set up industries. With strong infrastructure and peaceful environment, Uttarakhand has emerged as the choice of investors.

Pushkar Singh Dhami,
chief minister

The Uttarakhand government has unveiled a comprehensive action plan to bolster the Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) sector, with a focus on positioning the state as a global hub for startups, green industries, and high-quality local products. The new MSME policy emphasises sustainable, inclusive, and employment-generating enterprises, while ensuring ease of doing business for investors.

MSMES AT THE CORE OF STATE ECONOMY

Micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) are the backbone of Uttarakhand's economy, driving employment, local enterprise and value creation. The government's renewed focus on the sector is encouraging startups that harness local resources, alongside investments in renewable energy, green industries and clean manufacturing. By strengthening infrastructure, easing business processes and promoting local enterprise, these initiatives are attracting fresh investment, expanding manufacturing and creating new employment opportunities. Together, they are enabling MSMEs to contribute more strongly to economic growth, livelihoods and inclusive development across the state.

POLICY PUSH AND ACTION PLAN

To accelerate economic growth, Uttarakhand is strengthening both new and existing enterprises through technology

upgradation, easier access to finance and markets, streamlined procedures and investment incentives. The One District One Product (ODOP) and One District Two Products (ODTP) initiatives, supported by GI-tagging, are helping showcase the state's distinctive products, strengthen local value chains and expand market opportunities. Aligned with national programmes such as Startup India, Stand-Up India, Make in India and MUDRA, these efforts are attracting investment, encouraging entrepreneurship and strengthening the "Make in Uttarakhand" identity in wider markets.

INCLUSIVE AND SUSTAINABLE GROWTH

The government is committed to ensuring that growth in the MSME sector is inclusive, providing special support to women entrepreneurs, the Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities, and entrepreneurs with disabilities (Divyang). To assist these groups in scaling their businesses and accessing new opportunities, additional financial incentives, subsidies, and dedicated helplines are being introduced.

STRENGTHENING INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT

District Industry Centres (DICs) are being modernised to provide technical facilities, project preparation, and advisory support to

Financial incentives and subsidies

The new MSME policy provides a range of financial benefits to enterprises:

- ▶ Stamp duty reimbursement of upto 100% based on the category
- ▶ Capital subsidy of up to 50% on plant and machinery
- ▶ Extra capital investment subsidy of upto 5% under 'Priority' categories and upto 10% under 'Most Priority' categories
- ▶ An additional 5% subsidy for SC, ST, women, and divyang entrepreneurs
- ▶ Interest subsidy reimbursement of up to ₹21 lakh, depending upon the category
- ▶ Reimbursement of electricity duty for five years for new enterprises with a sanctioned load of up to 500 KW
- ▶ Recognition through ZED certification
- ▶ To encourage quality manufacturing, MSMEs are being offered certification under the Zero Defect Zero Effect (ZED) scheme. Units certified under gold, silver, and bronze categories receive recognition along with a monetary award of upto ₹75,000 per unit

entrepreneurs. A single-window clearance system is being streamlined to ensure faster approvals.

Additionally, an Investment Promotion and Facilitation Centre has been established at the Directorate of Industries to serve as a one-stop solution for investors and businesspersons. Special helpline services for women and differently-abled entrepreneurs are also being introduced.

FOCUS ON SKILL DEVELOPMENT AND MODERN TECHNIQUES

The policy also emphasises the need to equip young entrepreneurs with modern skills. To this end, the state is collaborating with reputed government and non-government organisations to provide training in:

- Manufacturing techniques
- Product design and packaging
- Marketing and branding strategies

MARKETING AND GLOBAL OUTREACH

The Uttarakhand Handloom and Handicraft Development Council is being engaged to promote state products in both national and international markets. Increased use of e-commerce platforms and commercial online portals will ensure that local enterprises gain greater visibility and a global reach. By encouraging innovation while preserving local traditions, the state aims to establish itself as a hub for sustainable and inclusive industries.

STATE'S NEW TOURISM SECTOR POLICY



INCENTIVES PROVIDED UNDER THE POLICY

The policy provides the following incentives to eligible tourism units:

- ▶ Capital subsidy for hospitality (accommodation-related projects)
- ▶ Capital Subsidy
- ▶ Incentives for marketing and promotion
- ▶ Incentives for training and skilling
- ▶ Interest subvention
- ▶ Incentive for waste treatment
- ▶ Incentive for generating bookings through State Online Travel Agency
- ▶ Capital subsidy for investments in tourism products and services
- ▶ Subsidies for projects and units not eligible for capital subsidy
- ▶ Incentive for high-value premium hospitality
- ▶ Incentives for foreign tourists
- ▶ Organisation of MICE, art, social and cultural events, fairs and festivals
- ▶ Incentives for promotion of Heli transport
- ▶ Exemption on electricity duty
- ▶ Exemption on stamp duty

The geographical, cultural, and environmental diversity of Uttarakhand has positioned it as one of the most visited states in North India. The number of tourists visiting Uttarakhand has consistently increased from ~22 million in 2014 to ~39 million in 2019 and registered a CAGR of 11.97%. A recent World Tourism and Travel Council (WTTC) report has pegged India as the 7th largest tourism economy globally in terms of absolute size and further forecasts the sector to grow at 7% between 2017 and 2027. The state of Uttarakhand is expected to match this trend in terms of tourist arrivals.

The state's new Tourism Policy envisages to chalk out a sustainable development strategy for tourism sector in the state. The role of the State Government and its Departments is envisaged to revolve around policy, regulation and promotion of tourism; while provision of services like accommodation, tourist facilitation, transportation, organisation of tours, activities, events, etc. will be the purview of the private sector, with State playing an enabling role.

LEVERAGING PRIVATE SECTOR INVESTMENTS

The policy underscores the fact that future tourism development in Uttarakhand would also benefit from private sector capital and expertise. In this regard, the government places immense faith in private-public sector relationships to further the cause of tourism development. For this to take effect expeditiously, the State would:

- i) reduce their role in areas where private

sector participation is encouraged (such as development and provision of accommodation), and
ii) enhance ease of doing business (investor facilitation) by strengthening single window clearance process for faster approvals of tourism entities.

ELIGIBLE TOURISM UNITS

This policy supports and incentivises both existing and planned tourism projects. For the purpose of eligibility for capital subsidy¹ under this policy, those projects / enterprises which are new as well as those going for expansion / diversification as of the date of application for subsidy shall be considered.

For eligibility for turnover-linked incentives under this policy, those projects / enterprises which are operational as of the date of application for subsidy shall be considered.

The state intends to concentrate its efforts on the following 'Focus Tourism':

Segments over the policy period:

- ▶ Nature and Adventure Tourism
- ▶ Health and Wellness Tourism
- ▶ Religious and Cultural Tourism
- ▶ Heritage Tourism
- ▶ MICE Tourism



Uttarakhand Pumped Storage Project Policy

This policy aims to set forth key objectives and mechanisms for development of Pumped Storage Projects in Uttarakhand. Pumped Storage Projects will be categorised in two main categories:

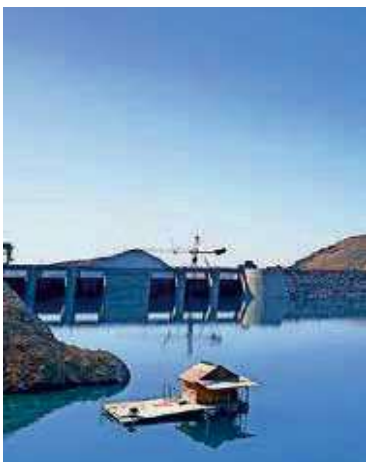
- **On-stream projects:** At least one storage located on river stream. The state government designated agency will identify on-stream projects from time to time. The projects may be allocated to CPSUs or State PSUs on nomination basis and to private developers through competitive bidding. The period of allocation and terms and conditions shall be as defined under this policy
- **Off-stream sites:** No storage located on river stream: The state government will invite developers to identify suitable sites for off-stream Pumped Storage Projects (PSPs) and submit proposals with details of their viability and storage potential. After evaluation, suitable projects will be

approved and formalised through an MoU/agreement with the developer

SUPPORT AND INCENTIVES

To encourage PSP development in state, the following support and incentives shall be offered:

- **Exemption of intra-state transmission charges:** PSP Developers shall be billed not more than 50% of intra-state transmission charges for a period of five years from the project CoD, if project CoD is before end of FY2033-34
- **Exemption of Local Area Development Fund:** Local Area Development Fund shall not be applicable to off-stream PSPs for the projects where power is purchased by state government
- **Exemption of free royalty power:** The state government shall not collect any free royalty power from Pumped Storage Projects



Policy objectives

Facilitate development of Pumped Storage Projects in the state and support state's growing energy demand in a sustainable manner.

- ▶ Harness the PSP potential in the state and encourage development of self-identified off-stream sites
- ▶ Leverage PSPs to generate public and private investment
- ▶ Encourage integration of renewable energy sources into the grid by promoting PSPs
- ▶ Leverage PSP storage to fulfil the drinking and irrigation needs of the regions wherever required and feasible

AYUSH Policy



AYUSH has remained a core part of Uttarakhand's culture and tradition over the years. The state has multiple natural and cultural endowments which make it an ideal destination for AYUSH.

Some key endowments include the presence of rare medicinal herbs, a well-established AYUSH manufacturing sector, a strong ancient community of practitioners and presence of destinations conducive for AYUSH healing.

KEY ACTIONS AND INCENTIVES

MEDICINAL PLANTS

- ▶ Promote Good Agricultural Practices (GAP), quality standards and technology such as drones for better cultivation and monitoring
- ▶ Develop cold-storage facilities and aggregation platforms
- ▶ Introduce assured buy-back mechanisms and promote medicinal-plant cultivation
- ▶ Build a distinctive Uttarakhand/ Himalayan brand for key medicinal

AYUSH MANUFACTURING

- ▶ Provide additional capital subsidies for eligible AYUSH manufacturing units and encourage cluster-based manufacturing
- ▶ Promote WHO-GMP, AYUSH premium and AYUSH standard certifications
- ▶ Establish common testing laboratories and a dedicated Homeopathic Drug Testing Laboratory
- ▶ Position Uttarakhand as a leading AYUSH manufacturing hub

HEALTHCARE

- ▶ Encourage NABH accreditation of

AYUSH hospitals and clinics through financial support and easier empanelment under state health schemes

- ▶ Strengthen government AYUSH hospitals and expand teleconsultation and digital healthcare services
- ▶ Promote Yoga as a tool for preventive healthcare and encourage private investment in AYUSH healthcare infrastructure
- ▶ Develop AYUSH Grams to involve local communities
- ▶ **WELLNESS**
 - ▶ Provide additional capital incentives for eligible wellness centres, hotels and resorts in hill regions
 - ▶ Promote AYUSH parks, yoga and meditation centres and wellness destinations through PPPs and private investment
 - ▶ Undertake domestic and international campaigns to position Uttarakhand as a leading global wellness destination

EDUCATION & RESEARCH

- ▶ Incentivise NAAC accreditation and strengthen the quality of AYUSH education
- ▶ Introduce apprenticeships, internships and research programmes through collaborations with leading national and international institution
- ▶ Promote research in Yoga, Naturopathy and the integration of traditional and modern medicine
- ▶ Strengthen faculty training, professional upskilling and documentation of Uttarakhand's traditional AYUSH knowledge



Kaverappa's strikes put South in command on the opening day

The pacer runs through North's lower middle-order in a four-wicket burst; opening batter Qamran, who was reprieved twice, scores a patient 76 with his unorthodox technique

DULEEP TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

Vidwath Kaverappa (four for 66) helped South Zone take the honours on day one of its Duleep Trophy semifinal against North Zone at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here on Sunday.

After opting to bat, North was shot out for 195, with opener Qamran Iqbal doing the bulk of the scoring with his unorthodox technique (76, 182b, 10x4, 1x6).

But the Jammu & Kashmir batter was reprieved twice by Ricky Bhui, who grassed a catch at first slip when Qamran was on 16 and fluffed an easy run-out just before lunch.

At stumps, South was 40 for two, having lost opener Bhui and one drop Shaik Rasheed in the space of 16 balls.

Much will depend on how the batting line-up – sans Karun Nair, who was not included in the playing XI – tackles the North pace trio of Gurnoor Brar, Arshdeep Singh and Anshul Kamboj in Monday's opening session.

On a pitch that visibly lacked pace, Kaverappa bowled a disciplined line, especially in his second



In a cluster: Kaverappa, centre, bagged all of his wickets in his second spell. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

spell where he picked up all four of his wickets (8-2-28-4).

North was in an advantageous position twice but couldn't capitalise. From 71 for one, it was reduced to 95 for four, with the highlight being the wicket of the dangerous Abdul Samad, who was caught splendidly by a diving R. Smaran at slip off leggie Shreyas Gopal.

Qamran and skipper Kanhaiya Wadhawan took North to 161 for four only

for Kaverappa to run through the lower middle-order by removing Nishant Sindhu, Abid Mushtaq and Kamboj – all of them decent batters – after left-arm spinner Tanay Thyagarajann bowled Wadhawan. Kaverappa accounted for Qamran too, with the batter's attempted hook after walking down the pitch ending as a catch to 'keeper N. Jagadeesan.

On the adjacent ground, defending champion Central Zone fared much bet-

ter, making 266 against East Zone. Rinku Singh top-scored with a brisk 60 (88b, 8x4), and there was also a 45-run partnership for the last wicket between Aryan Panday (22, 46b, 2x4) and Yash Thakur (30 n.o., 26b, 6x4).

The scores: North Zone 195 in 59.1 overs (Qamran Iqbal 76, Vidwath Kaverappa 4/66) vs. South Zone 40/2 in 18 overs; **Toss:** North. Central Zone 266 in 80.1 overs (Aryan Juyal 46, Rinku Singh 60) vs. East Zone; **Toss:** East.

Used injury break to become a better bowler: Kaverappa



Making it count: Kaverappa has ensured a good start to the new domestic season. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

In the eight months from July 2023 to February 2024, Vidwath Kaverappa's career was on an upward trajectory.

The Karnataka pacer was the Player of the Series in Duleep Trophy (15 wickets in two games), played for India-A against South Africa-A and England Lions, and took 25 wickets from five matches in the 2023-24 Ranji Trophy at an average of 20.16.

But the 2024-25 season was a washout, troubled as he was by a stress fracture in his shin, and played just two First Class games.

In 2025-26, he was fit, but was not an automatic choice when V. Vyshak and Prasidh Krishna were available, missing out on the Ranji Trophy semifinal and final, against Uttarakhand and Jammu & Kashmir, respectively.

However, with a four-wicket haul for South Zone on the opening day of the 2026-27 Duleep Trophy semifinal versus North

Zone, Kaverappa signalled his desire to make the upcoming campaign count and return to his best.

"I am not really over the moon or something like that," the 27-year-old told reporters on Sunday at the BCCI Centre of Excellence. "I'm just taking one game at a time and not thinking too far ahead. I know the kind of bowling I can produce. So I cannot relax or be complacent with this."

Kaverappa admitted that the injury came at a wrong time in his career, but stated that he used the break to become a better bowler.

"I just thought about what best I can do and what I can add to my arsenal. And that's how I added a little bit more strength, and made a few corrections to my action."

Between then and now, Kaverappa said that he was a lot more mature.

"I am more in tune with my bowling. I am not chasing things that don't work. I just focus on things that work and use it at the best possible time."



Robinson rocks as England wins series

PAKISTAN IN ENGLAND

Agence France-Presse
LONDON

England clinched a series victory over Pakistan with a thumping 194-run win in the second Test at Lord's here on Sunday.

Pakistan, set an improbable target of 389, was dismissed for 194 on the fourth day to hand England an unbeatable 2-0 lead in the three-match series.

Pacer Ollie Robinson tormented Pakistan again, taking two wickets in four balls, before express fast bowler Jofra Archer dismissed Pakistan captain Babar Azam to leave the away team at 14 for three.

While Robinson also accounted for Shan Masood and Mohammad Rizwan in back-to-back overs, Saud Shakeel (97) restored some self-respect for Pakistan



Robinson. GETTY IMAGES

before he holed out to fast bowler Josh Tongue, who polished off the tail.

Pakistan was much happier in the first hour, with the 36-year-old Mohammad Abbas making it to the Lord's honours board for the first time after bowling England out for 208.

The scores: England 290 & 208 in 54.2 overs (Lawrence 54, Abbas 5/57) bt Pakistan 110 & 194 in 50.5 overs (Shakeel 97, Robinson 4/24).

Kairav, Rehan, Shiv and Aruthran book berths in IAME Asia Finals

MOTORSPORTS

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Kairav Roberson (MSPORT), Rehan Khan Rasheed (Momentum Motorsports), Shiv Neel (NKRA by KKM) and Aruthran Prabhu (Kartkrew Motorsports) emerged overall winners in the senior, junior, mini and mini under-10 categories of the inaugural IAME Series India 2026 at the Madras International Karting Arena here on Saturday night.

Kairav, who topped all sessions, completed his dominance by crossing the line first in the super heat and final.

Rehan sealed the junior title, taking the second spot in super heat and winning the final.

Shiv secured the mini crown despite finishing second in the finale, as he had a points advantage over Rudra Gokulnath going into the decider.

The four champions booked tickets to the IAME Asia Finals in Macau (December 11 to 13).

Kartkrew Motorsports clinched the senior and under-10 titles while Momentum Motorsports (junior) and NKRA by KKM (mini) were the other winners.

The results (provisional):
X30-125cc: Seniors: Final (8 laps): 1. Kairav Roberson (MSPORT) 8:16.115s; 2. Vansh Benani (Kartkrew Motorsports) 8:59.062s; 3. V.V. Viswajit (Kartkrew Motorsports), 9:09.842s.
Super Heat (14 laps): 1. Kairav 11:41.664s; 2. Jaden Hadriel (MSPORT) 12:04.984s; 3. Vansh 12:06.116s.
Juniors: Final (8 laps): 1. Rehan Khan Rasheed (Momentum Motorsports) 8:48.336s; 2. Abhishikt Barse (Crest



Dashing: Rehan, right, took home the junior title after coming up trumps in the final.



Doing enough: Shiv earned the top prize in the mini class despite finishing second.



On top: IAME Series India 2026 overall winners Kairav, Aruthran, Shiv and Rehan. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Motorsports) 8:57.420s; 3. Adithya Prathap (Momentum) 9:17.334s.

Super Heat (12 laps): 1. Barse 10:13.092s; 2. Yashvinraam Rajamanickam (Momentum) 10:20.418s; 3. Rehan 10:21.017s.

X30-60cc mini class: Final (6 laps): 1. Rudra Gokulnath (NKRK

by KKM) 6:50.889s; 2. Shiv Neel (NKRA) 6:51.738s; 3. Ridhaan Anil Kumarr (Red Rabbit Racers) 7:12.822s.

Super Heat (9 laps): 1. Shiv 8:20.451s; 2. Rudra 8:20.474s; 3. Ridhaan 8:26.484s.

Mini under-10: Finals (6 laps):

1. Aruthran Prabhu (Katkrew) 7:07.114s; 2. Ayansh Patil (MSPORT) 7:29.061s; 3. Abdur Rehman (Momentum) 7:43.208.

Super Heat (9 laps): 1. Ayansh 8:25.730s; 2. Aruthran 8:30.493s; 3. Guru Tharun (Kartkrew) 8:31.356s.



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R. Kaushik

Even before November 1999, a host of exceptional wicketkeeper-batters had graced the international scene, not least India's own Farokh Engineer and the wonderful Andy Flower from Zimbabwe. But from the time a left-hander from Western Australia stormed the Test firmament at the Gabba in Brisbane nearly 27 years back with a bruising 81 on debut, against a shell-shocked Pakistani outfit, wicketkeeper-batters have been looked at in an entirely different vein.

Adam Gilchrist rewrote the dynamics of Test batsmanship. He was a destructive opener in limited-overs cricket long before he played his first Test, and reeled off numerous wondrous knocks, including in the final of the 50-over 2007 World Cup when, with a squash ball for company, he bludgeoned his way to 149 against Mahela Jaywardene's Sri Lanka in a decisive effort that took Australia to a hat-trick of titles. But it was in the red-ball game that Gilchrist set stall as a pioneer, providing not just meaningful heft to the Australian batting but scoring runs at such a furious clip that opponents were often ducking, unsuccessfully, for cover.

For the most part of his glittering career that encompassed 96 Tests, the left-hander had the luxury of batting behind a grand top six that used different methodologies to subjugate bowling attacks in all parts of the world. The sight of Gilchrist, the destroyer supreme, striding in purposefully at No. 7, was dispiriting or exhilarating, depending on which side of the fence one was. Gilchrist seldom disappointed; when he scored his runs, he did so with not just panache and chutzpah but also with a violent streak that damaged bowling figures as well as egos. How could anyone bat with such unchecked aggression at No. 7? How could someone fuse a no-holds-barred approach with such consistency (as an average of 47.60 at a strike-rate of 81.95 will unequivocally testify to)?

Gold standard
Gilchrist will remain the gold standard among wicketkeeper-batters, the platform from which the likes of Mahendra Singh Dhoni, more than anyone else, launched himself into the stratosphere. Gilchrist's towering presence kept an entire

generation - or more - of Aussie stumper-batters out of international reckoning. India, however, found a judicious balance; while Dhoni's aggression in front of the stumps and his brilliance behind it precluded a dynamic new force breaking through, India were

compelled to find a place, if only as a specialist batter, for Dinesh Karthik, the ebullient little right-hander from Chennai who was more than good enough to hold his own as a batter.

Karthik wasn't the first Indian gloveman to play as a specialist batter. Nearly four decades before him, Budhi Kunderan donned that role, even opening the batting in England in 1967 alongside designated wicketkeeper Engineer. A couple of decades on, Chandrakant Pandit played as a middle-order bat with Kiran More slotting in as the wicketkeeper. Such was Karthik's great natural ability - which he didn't maximise, he will acknowledge - that in the Dhoni era, India fielded him as a full-fledged opener overseas, and with no little success. Alongside Wasim Jaffer, Karthik formed an excellent opening combine in Bangladesh and England in 2007, bringing up his only Test ton across the border and bettering that effort by emerging as India's highest scorer in England, when they last won a Test series there by a slender 1-0 margin.

Karthik played his last eight Tests down the order, sometimes when Dhoni wasn't available (including through retirement) and he donned the big gloves, and at others when he played alongside the Jharkhandi as a pure batter. Just one half-century in his last 14 Test innings meant he played the last of his 26 Tests in August 2018; his Test average of 25 was decidedly underwhelming, given his supreme gift as a batter, but that can happen when one is overeager and anxious to not just justify their selection but also state their case for a longer rope.

India now have a profusion of excellent wicketkeeper-batters across formats - Rishabh Pant, of course, tops that chart, especially when it comes to the red-ball variant, but there are a host of others that can't be ignored. Among them are Sanju Samson and Ishan Kishan, exclusive when it comes to the white-ball version. And Dhruv Jurel, the 25-year-old from Agra whose first Test cap came as a wicketkeeper against England in Rajkot in February 2024 when Pant was out after his horrific road accident of 14 months previously and KS Bharat had played himself out of the XI with poor efforts in the first two Tests in Hyderabad and Visakhapatnam respectively.

The generational talent that Pant is, he kept almost exclusively from the time he made his Test debut in Nottingham in August 2018 and made a stunning 114 in his third appearance at the Oval till his single-car accident in December 2022

Jurel — a blend of versatility and fortitude

The decision-makers continued to invest their belief in him and the batter has responded in style. Towards the end of June, he was a part of the India 'A' squad that travelled on the 'shadow' tour of Sri Lanka for two unofficial 'Tests'



AP

when India were suddenly forced to scramble for a replacement. Bharat, from Andhra, won the early nod for the home Tests against Australia in February 2023 and donned the big gloves in the final of the World Test Championship against the same opponents that June. KL Rahul was nominated the first-choice stumper for the two Tests in South Africa towards the end of the year, more to provide stability and class to the lower order in a line-up from which very few had played in South Africa previously. Bharat reclaimed his spot behind the sticks against England at home and played himself out of the XI following scores of 41, 28, 17 and 6 which meant that in seven Tests and 12 innings, he only averaged 20.09, a definite no-no given that the wicketkeeper's was no longer a single-discipline specialised slot.

Out went the call to Jurel for the third Test in Rajkot with the series finely poised at 1-1, and it was immediately apparent that India had hit upon a gold mine. The right-hander made a poised 46 on debut, and upped the ante in the next match with scores of 90 and 39 not out, the first ensuring that India didn't end up conceding a massive lead and the second taking them home in a tense run-chase when he and Shubman Gill put on 72 for the unfinished sixth-wicket stand.

This was in February 2024, when one wasn't sure when Pant would be available for selection though in a characteristic show of gumption and guts, the stocky left-hander was far ahead of the timelines the doctors had tentatively outlined for a possible comeback to competitive cricket. Pant was ready for international cricket in September that year, making a remarkable recovery from a series of potentially life-threatening injuries to smash 109 on his comeback Test in Chennai against Bangladesh. Suddenly, Jurel faced an uncertain future. Despite an impressive start to his Test career, he had to bow before the irrepressible force that Pant was, though it was always on the cards that he could slot in alongside Pant, if not necessarily ahead of him.

In six of his last nine Tests, Jurel has occupied a specialist batter's position between No. 4 and No. 8 (and that only

because Akash Deep was employed as a nightwatchman at the Oval last August). On the three occasions when was the designated wicketkeeper, Pant was unavailable through injury after breaking his right foot in the Manchester Test against England in July last year. Despite the vast array of batting riches at India's disposal, head coach Gautam Gambhir has identified in Jurel a dependable batting option, and the man from Uttar Pradesh has comprehensively justified that faith with two hundreds and a fifty in those nine Tests and 15 innings.

Jurel's coming-of-age moment, if it can be called that, transpired in Ahmedabad last October with Pant still to recover from the broken foot. In India's only innings against West Indies, he uncorked an excellent 125, then followed it up with 44 in the next Test in Delhi. With Pant returning to action against South Africa in November, Jurel continued on as a batter alone though like the rest of his colleagues, he had a series to forget with outings of 14, 13, 0 and 2 in a disastrous 0-2 result that has comprehensively dented India's hopes of making a third WTC final in four cycles.

But instead of pressing the panic button and looking elsewhere, the decision-makers continued to invest their belief in him and Jurel has responded in style. Towards the end of June, he was a part of the India 'A' squad that travelled on the 'shadow' tour of Sri Lanka for two unofficial 'Tests', ostensibly at the insistence of Gambhir because of his felicity against the turning ball. Jurel warmed up nicely for the Test series to follow with scores of 141 not out, 14 and 53, and it was no surprise that he was picked for the first Test in Galle, when he weighed in with 51 and 7 in a winning cause.

In Colombo last week, Jurel went one better with an unbeaten 115 during which he brought his technical expertise and his mental fortitude into play. He also kept wickets for a while when Pant was recovering from a blow to his right shoulder sustained while batting, and when he went back to the outfield, took a terrific running catch from point to get rid of Lahiru Kumara in Sri Lanka's first

innings. At every stage in every role, he has looked the part, making his presence felt with total commitment and a never-say-die spirit without seeking recourse to the flashy and the flamboyant.

Jurel was chosen for Sri Lanka for his ability to play spin with finesse, and it is hard now to see him being overlooked during the November Test tour of New Zealand where the challenges for batters will be vastly different. At No. 6, behind Pant, he has the technique to tackle the second new ball if that is what he is confronted with. Ravindra Jadeja behind him in the batting order and the possible return of Washington Sundar from injury mean he is a right-handed option around a plethora of left-handers, and while that alone can't be a qualification, he has shown that he can hold his own against bowling of any kind in any conditions.

India are fortunate that in Jurel, they have a three-in-one cricketer with his entire future ahead of him. As a batting average of 40.68 from 12 Tests proves, he is every bit

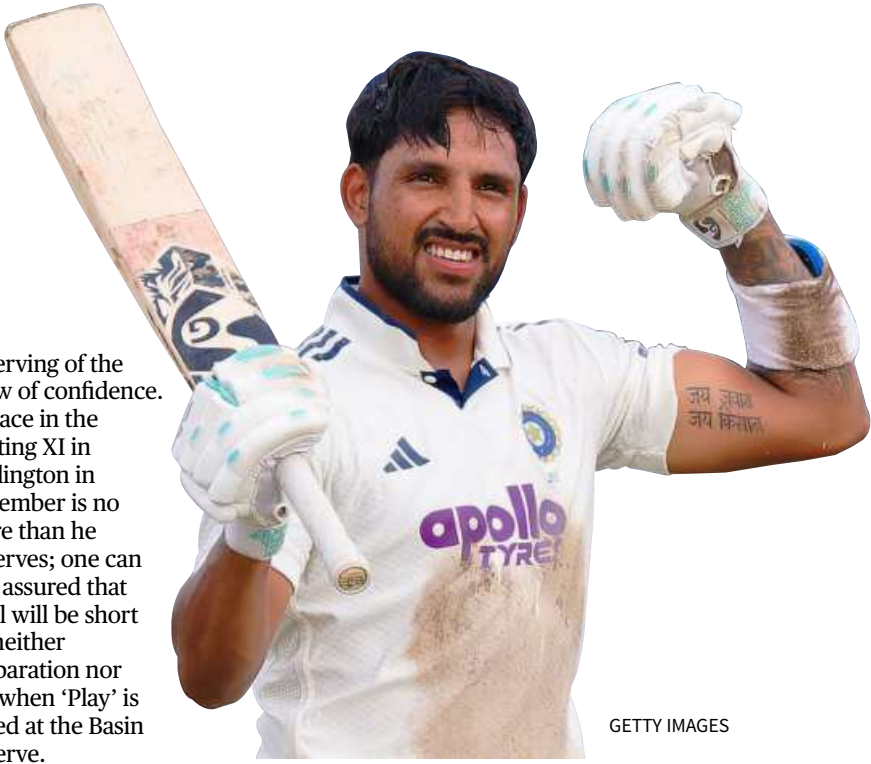
THE GIST

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As a batting average of 40.68 from 12 Tests proves, he deserves the show of confidence. A place in the starting XI in Wellington in November is no more than he deserves. One can rest assured that Jurel will be short on neither preparation nor fire

deserving of the show of confidence. A place in the starting XI in Wellington in November is no more than he deserves; one can rest assured that Jurel will be short on neither preparation nor fire when 'Play' is called at the Basin Reserve.



GETTY IMAGES

How a star with an extreme magnetic field could prove space is not empty

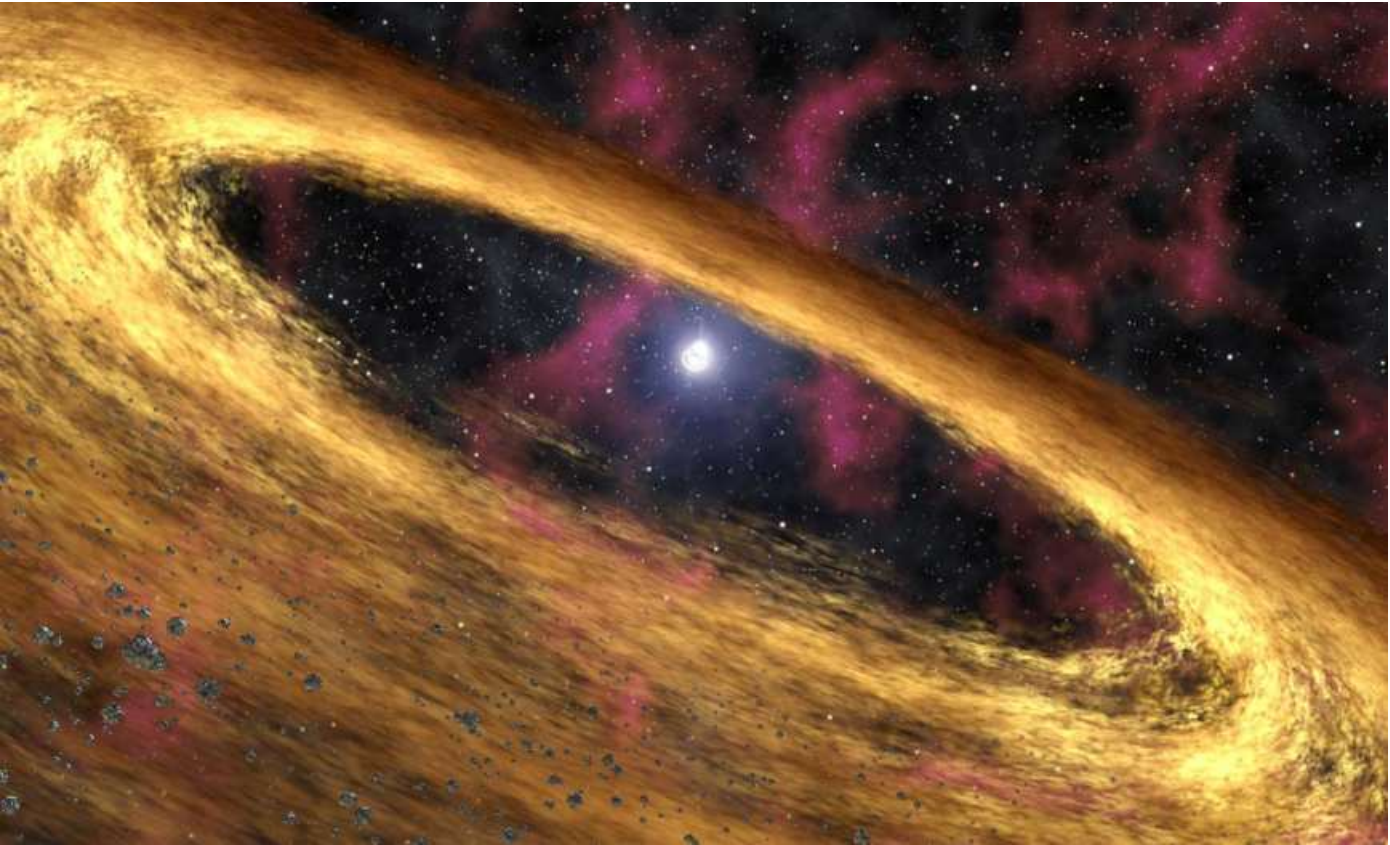
The work could pave the way to show that the ‘nothingness’ of space is actually a complex and active medium, and help scientists refine their maps of the universe

Vasudevan Mukunth

Quantum physics has made numerous strange predictions, and scientists have checked and confirmed many of them. But one of the strangest ones persists unresolved. In the 1930s, the German physicists Werner Heisenberg and Hans Heinrich Euler proposed that empty space is not really empty. Instead, they predicted that in the presence of a magnetic field, the vacuum of space would behave like a crystal, changing the properties of light passing through it. The trouble with testing this prediction – called vacuum birefringence – is that the magnetic field has to be extraordinarily strong. In a study published in *Nature* on August 5, astronomers from Australia, Canada, Japan, South Africa, Taiwan, and the U.S. reported it had observed such birefringence using two satellites and a telescope in Australia, almost confirming the prediction at long last. The work could prove ‘nothingness’ is actually a complex and active medium and also potentially help scientists refine their maps of the universe.

Staggering numbers

In classical physics, a vacuum is absolute nothingness. But in quantum electrodynamics (QED) – which is a theory in quantum physics – a vacuum is a soup of virtual particles: pairs of electrons and anti-electrons that constantly pop in and out of existence, and so quickly that they cannot be observed. Normally, these virtual particles have a negligible effect on light. But when a magnetic field nearby becomes strong enough, it changes how the short-lived charged particles can move, so they respond differently to light depending on the direction in which its electric field is vibrating. This part of space will then behave like a calcite crystal when light passes through it, splitting it into different paths depending on its electric field. (As an electromagnetic wave, light consists of electric and magnetic fields travelling through space.) For vacuum birefringence to become noticeable, the magnetic field has to be around 88 trillion times stronger than the earth’s magnetic field, and more than 500 million times as strong as the ultra-powerful magnets in the world’s largest science experiment, the CERN supercollider. These are staggering numbers far beyond the abilities of current technologies, so physicists have been looking for proof of vacuum birefringence in outer space, where objects called magnetars generate the



An artist's impression of the magnetar 4U 0142+61. In May 2022, the IXPE satellite had hinted at vacuum birefringence around this dead star. NASA

universe’s most extreme magnetic fields. Sometimes the core of a dead star can collapse to form a neutron star. Neutron stars with powerful magnetic fields are called magnetars. **Railroading polarisation** The international team focused its attention on one magnetar named 1E 1547.0-5408, located 14,700 lightyears away. As independent experts Ekaterina Sokolova-Lapa and Joern Wilms wrote in a commentary accompanying the team’s paper, “1E 1547.0-5408 belongs to a rare subclass of magnetars that also emit pulses at radio wavelengths”. By combining X-ray and radio frequency measurements, then, the team could piece together the geometry of the magnetar’s magnetic field. If the vacuum of space were truly empty – as in classical physics – the X-rays from the magnetar would reach the earth with a low degree of polarisation. But the team found the opposite: the NASA Imaging X-ray Polarimetry Explorer (IXPE) satellite in particular detected very high levels of polarisation, up to 80% in some instances, which is the smoking gun of vacuum birefringence. As X-rays leave the magnetar and move through the surrounding space, QED predicts that their electric field will have to lock itself into one of two directions – a condition that unmagnetised space does not impose – thus polarising the light.

Since these directions are defined by the direction of the magnetic field, the X-rays’ polarisation is effectively railroaded along the magnetic field lines. And as the X-rays travel away from the magnetar, their polarisation will stay fixed even as the magnetic field becomes less and less able to ‘hold on’. According to the team, the amount of polarisation dropped as the energy of the X-rays increased, which QED predicts as well. The team was also able to elucidate that the magnetar rotated along an axis that aligned almost perfectly with its magnetic poles, like a top spinning upright – a detail that informed the team’s models of how the X-rays from the magnetar would look with and without vacuum birefringence. The models that did not account for the phenomenon fit substantially worse with the telescope data than those that included it. **Direct observation** Other than IXPE, the team had also used the Neutron Star Interior Composition Explorer instrument onboard the International Space Station and the Murriyang radio telescope in Australia. The finding takes a big step towards bolstering space’s character as a complex medium that both gravity and magnetism can manipulate. On a final note, the team wrote in its paper that its next goal is “to more

directly probe the nature of the ... polarisation”. And this, the commentary noted, requires “coordinated astronomical campaigns that observe multiple magnetars and cover a wider part of the electromagnetic spectrum”. The current finding is indirect because the astronomers recorded polarised light and inferred from that that it had passed through extremely magnetised space. **Not yet proven** As Sokolova-Lapa and Wilms put it, the high polarisation reported in the study only proves vacuum birefringence if the team’s model of the magnetar’s geometry is correct. If, instead, its axis of rotation and magnetic poles are further apart, the X-rays could have been polarised by plasma on the magnetar’s surface. A paper published in *The Astrophysical Journal* by researchers from Italy, Spain, and the U.K. has already raised doubts about the alignment. Physicists are also interested in the vacuum resonance: a distinctive dip in the polarisation – from one of the two allowed directions to the other – at a specific energy level. The international team itself reported a dip but said it was too noisy to be dispositive. But one way or another, the dark voids between the stars we see when we look up are far from dead, buzzing with activity. (mukunth.v@thehindu.co.in)

THE GIST

In the presence of strong magnetic fields, a phenomenon called vacuum birefringence can make the vacuum of space behave like a crystal and polarise light passing through it. Using NASA’s IXPE satellite, NICER instrument, and Australia’s Murriyang radio telescope, researchers observed highly polarised X-rays from magnetar 1E 1547.0-5408, matching predictions made by quantum electrodynamics (QED). The evidence depends on models of the magnetar’s geometry, and some scientists suggest the observed polarisation could instead be caused by plasma near the star; further observations of more magnetars are needed for a direct confirmation.

BIG SHOT



A worker at a robusta coffee bean plantation in Sao Gabriel da Palha, Brazil. A new study has challenged the widely held belief that robusta coffee is more resilient to climate change than other varieties, with its lead author in an interview calling it an ‘Internet myth’ based on flawed research that overlooked the crop’s drought intolerance and other vulnerabilities. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Nancy Grace Roman Telescope



A computer generated model of the Nancy Grace Roman Telescope. NASA

Reuters

NASA is preparing to launch its next flagship space observatory — one scientists plan to use to investigate some of the universe’s biggest mysteries, including dark energy and dark matter, while also testing gravity at vast scales and hunting for planets beyond our solar system. The Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope is a roughly \$4-billion project. At the time of writing, it was planned for a Sunday launch from the NASA Kennedy Space Center in Florida. The observatory will be lofted into orbit aboard a SpaceX Falcon Heavy rocket. The telescope is named after the late Nancy Grace Roman, NASA’s first chief astronomer. It is a follow-on to the Hubble Space Telescope, launched in 1990, and the James Webb Space Telescope, launched in 2021, and has capabilities that can expand on the knowledge gained by those pioneering observatories, both of which also still operate. The telescope’s

main survey will take more than a year, per Roman’s senior project scientist Julie McEnery. “The survey will contain over two billion galaxies and enable us to study how the structures in our universe — the stars, the galaxies, the clusters of galaxies — grew and evolved. We’ll also measure how our universe has expanded over time,” she said. After launch and separation from the rocket, the telescope will travel towards a location called Lagrange point 2, about 1.6 million km from the earth. Webb also resides at this location. U.S. President Donald Trump tried during both his first and second terms to reduce or eliminate funding for Roman but the Congress preserved it.



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Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Rehabilitation centres in Mizoram for drug addicts

48 Mizoram has 48 centres and homes providing care and rehabilitation services to 5,224 people affected by drug addiction, officials said on Sunday. The State government provided ₹42 lakh as financial assistance to these centres and homes. PTI

Number of doctors to be recruited by Himachal govt.

650 Speaking at the inauguration of a health camp, Himachal Pradesh CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu said that the government is going to recruit 300 medical officers, 200 specialist doctors and 150 super-specialist doctors. PTI

Heat-related deaths seen in Austria in June and July

646 Austria saw its highest-ever recorded number of heat-related deaths this June and July, the country's health agency said on Sunday. The AGES agency said those two months saw 646 heat-related deaths. AFP

Amount sanctioned by J&K govt. to repair migrant flats

82 in ₹ crore. The Jammu and Kashmir government has approved a ₹82.45-crore repair project for 5,000 flats across Jammu's migrant camps. Public Works Department officials said that repair and renovation would be taken up soon. PTI

People aboard ferry that capsized off coast of northern Cyprus

267 At least seven people have died after a ferry carrying at least 267 passengers and crew capsized off the coast of northern Cyprus on Sunday, Turkish media reported. AP
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OBC creamy layer and the income test

Why is the Centre finding the ruling difficult to implement? What exactly did the Supreme Court rule on the creamy layer? Why is the Centre seeking clarification? What are its concerns over implementing the ruling? What happens next in the creamy layer case?

EXPLAINER

Abhinay Lakshman

The story so far:

The Supreme Court has said it will consider setting up a Bench to hear the Centre's application seeking clarification over its March 11 judgment on the income test component of the OBC creamy layer exclusion criteria. Retrospectively implementing the judgment on the income/wealth test for OBC creamy layer determination is “extremely difficult” and will cause a “cascading effect” in the settled services from 2012 till now, with the impact extending to “all categories, including the Unreserved category”, the Centre said in a batch of applications.

Why does the Centre call the ruling ‘extremely difficult’ to implement?

The Supreme Court on March 11 delivered its judgment in a batch of cases pending for close to a decade, relating to how the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) should interpret the crucial income/wealth test, which is one of the layers through which the “creamy layer” (or relatively socially and economically forward) among the Other Backward Classes communities is excluded from availing the benefit of reservation.

The cases that eventually came before the court involved claims by at least 50 OBC candidates who had appeared in Civil Services Examinations (CSE) since 2015 and were excluded from consideration for an OBC-reserved post after the DoPT classified them as part of the creamy layer solely based on their parents’ income.

The Supreme Court found that the DoPT was incorrectly applying the income test for this category of OBC candidates and directed the government to create supernumerary posts for the OBC candidates to whom the income test had been applied with what it called “hostile discrimination,” and allot them services according to their ranks in their respective CSE years.

What are the criteria for exclusion?

The creamy layer concept among OBCs emerged from the Supreme Court's 1992 ruling in the *Indra Sawhney* case, which paved the way for the implementation of OBC reservations. The idea was to exclude OBC candidates whose families had accumulated social and economic privileges over the years from the benefits of reservation. Such candidates came to be described as belonging to the “creamy layer”.

To clarify which categories of OBC candidates would fall under the creamy layer, the DoPT issued an Office Memorandum [(OM), a guiding charter] in September 1993, laying down the criteria for exclusion.

The OM prescribed several categories of exclusion, including children of senior constitutional, judicial, government and armed forces officers.

Besides this, the DoPT also prescribed a crucial income or wealth test, applicable to people in the salaried professional class or engaged in trade; people holding plantations, vacant land and/or buildings in urban areas; and people whose parents held posts in Central or State PSUs where the equivalence of these posts with government service posts had not yet been established. It is this last category, that is, children of parents holding posts in Central or State PSUs or in private employment, that the court delivered its March 11 judgment.



GETTY IMAGES

What was the problem with the 1993 OM and 2004 letter?

Under the 1993 DoPT OM on the income/wealth test for OBC reservations, a candidate would be considered part of the creamy layer if their parents’ gross family income exceeded the prescribed limit for three consecutive years, or if they possessed wealth above the exemption limit prescribed under the Wealth Tax Act, 1957. The income limit, which was ₹1 lakh when the 1993 OM was issued, was revised several times and now stands at ₹8 lakh, with the last revision having come in 2017. Importantly, the 1993 DoPT OM specified that income from salaries and agricultural land should be excluded when applying the income/wealth test, with income from other sources such as property, business, or capital gains being considered.

However, in October 2004, the DoPT issued a letter meant to clarify issues that had arisen in interpreting the 1993 OM. In paragraph 9 of this letter, the DoPT took up the issue of how to calculate income for the income/wealth test for OBCs whose parents were in Central or State PSUs where equivalence of posts had not yet been established. The DoPT seemed to suggest that income from salaries was to be counted to determine if the income was above the prescribed threshold for three consecutive years. The threshold was subsequently revised to ₹8 lakh per year in 2017.

In the 2026 ruling, the Division Bench noted that until the government establishes equivalence between the posts of Central or State PSUs and government services, the income/wealth test must continue to apply equally.

How did the Supreme Court interpret the income test?

The March 11 *Union of India vs Rohith Nathan* judgment said that OBC candidates whose parents work in PSUs or the private sector, where the government has yet to establish equivalence of posts with government services, cannot be treated differently from OBC candidates in other categories under the creamy layer exclusion criteria.

Significantly, the Supreme Court ruled that the income/wealth test component of the exclusion exercise must be seen and operated as a “residual filter”, adding that salaries and agricultural incomes had been consciously left out while applying this test under the 1993 OM. The court found that while the 1993 OM was clear about excluding income from salaries from the calculation of the income/wealth test, the 2004 letter appeared to call for its inclusion in circumstances that were

not clearly specified.

The court went on to note that the interpretation of the 1993 OM, read with the 2004 letter, had led to “hostile discrimination” between the children of those in government service and those in PSUs or private employment.

Without establishing equivalence of posts, the income test, including salaries, was being applied to rule out OBC candidates whose parents were not in government service, while OBC candidates whose parents were in government service were being subjected to a test that did not include salaries. This is what the court had described as “hostile discrimination”.

The court said, “Treating the children of those employed in PSUs or private employment, etc., as being excluded from the benefit of reservation only on the basis of their income derived from salaries, and without reference to their posts (whether Group A or B, or Group C or D) would certainly lead to hostile discrimination between parties who are similarly placed and would amount to equals being treated unequally.”

The court had directed the Centre to implement this reading of the income test within six months by creating supernumerary posts for the petitioners, who were OBC candidates in the Civil Services Examinations and had been excluded from the creamy layer on account of their parents’ salaries alone. The parents were working in public sector undertakings or the private sector.

Did the Centre try to implement the Supreme Court's directions?

The Supreme Court's ruling in the *Rohith Nathan* case was a watershed moment for this category of OBCs, who had said that the issue had been pending for more than a decade. As per the Supreme Court's direction, the Union government was supposed to issue further instructions in pursuance of the court's reading of the income test component – on how the supernumerary posts must be created and how the existing strength of the services must be adjusted to accommodate them.

According to government records, the Union Ministry of Personnel, Pensions and Public Grievances wrote to the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment on June 3, seeking advice on implementing the directions of the *Rohith Nathan* judgment. The Personnel Ministry told the Social Justice Secretary that the Allocation of Business Rules provide for the Social Justice Ministry to formulate policy on reservations and that it was therefore seeking

“clarification/action” in this regard. The Personnel Ministry further sought “advice on instructions to be adopted or notified” by the DoPT.

As of August 19, the Centre's position before the Central Administrative Tribunal in a matter identical to that of the aggrieved OBC candidates in the *Rohith Nathan* case was that it was in the process of implementing the March 11 judgment.

However, a few days later, the DoPT filed an application highlighting why it was seemingly impossible to follow the Supreme Court's directions and the issues that were arising in implementing them retrospectively. In this application, the Centre said that despite its efforts to create the supernumerary posts as called for in the *Rohith Nathan* judgment, it was facing an increasing number of claims for adjustment, issues of seniority arising from such adjustments, and concerns that even this exercise could be “unfair” to a different category of OBC candidates and candidates of “all categories, including the unreserved category”.

The Centre noted that since the March 11 judgment, 22 other judgments have been issued by courts applying the principles laid out in *Rohith Nathan*. In addition, the DoPT said that 12 new cases have been filed seeking reconsideration of OBC non-creamy layer status under the Rohith Nathan principles, by candidates who had not previously approached the courts.

However, OBC candidates who spoke to *The Hindu* argued that the Centre's reluctance to implement the directions does not appear to make sense. These candidates have asked why the DoPT had not mentioned these larger issues with implementation earlier.

These candidates have noted that the older reading of the income test – the one that the court said practised “hostile discrimination” – was being applied only by the DoPT, and that too arbitrarily.

What happens next?

Along with the application that the DoPT has filed setting out the difficulties it was facing in implementing the *Rohith Nathan* judgment's directions, especially retrospectively, the Union government had filed a separate application, seeking that it be allowed to continue allotting services as per the old reading of the income test for CSE 2025 candidates, and seeking clarification on how to implement the directions. The Centre said that more than 950 CSE 2025 candidates were about to start their Foundation Course and that they had been recommended based on the old reading of the income test.

The DoPT argued, in this application, that the retrospective application of the judgment was specifically running into the issues mentioned above.

The Supreme Court has now said it will consider setting up a Bench to hear the Centre's request for clarification on how to implement its directions and its request to allow the allotment of services to CSE 2025 candidates to continue as settled for the time being.

However, in the other application filed along with this, the Centre has asked for clarification on how to implement the direction overall. It has further argued that there might be some value in including income from salaries, as in some cases it might be the “sole intelligible differentia” between two OBC candidates from “similar social backgrounds”. It has also argued that, in the absence of salary consideration, some cases might lead to OBC candidates with parents earning up to ₹1 crore being considered non-creamy layer.

Now, the question is: how far will the Supreme Court's March 11 verdict reach?

THE GIST

The Supreme Court's March 11 ruling held that salary income should not be used to exclude OBC candidates from the creamy layer where their parents work in PSUs or private employment without established equivalence of posts with government service.

The Centre says retrospective implementation could have a ‘cascading effect’ on settled services, while triggering fresh claims from candidates who were previously denied OBC non-creamy-layer status.

The Supreme Court will consider setting up a Bench to hear the Centre's plea for clarification on implementing the ruling, including its application to CSE 2025 candidates.

